2021-2022 Academic Year Fall Semester
MDB2051 READING AND SPEAKING IN ENGLISH
COURSE INFORMATION FORM

FACULTY / GRADUATE SCHOOL	School of Foreign Languages
DEPARTMENT / PROGRAMME	Modern Languages Department
TITLE OF COURSE	Reading and Speaking in English
CODE	MDB2051
LOCAL CREDIT	2
ECTS	2
LECTURE HOUR / WEEK	2
PRACTICAL HOUR / WEEK	0
LABORATORY HOUR / WEEK	0
PREREQUISITE	--
SEMESTER	Fall
COURSE LANGUAGE	English
LEVEL OF COURSE	Undergraduate
COURSE TYPE	Social Elective
COURSE CATEGORY	General Education
MODE OF DELIVERY	Face-to-face
OWNER ACADEMIC UNIT	Modern Languages Department
INSTRUCTOR(S)	Instructors of Modern Languages Department
ASSISTANT (S)	--
COURSE OBJECTIVES	• reading a passage/listening to a lecture about the same topic and identifying the main points of both texts in order to respond to them orally • providing topics of discussion in a variety of fields with a particular focus on art, social science and scientific innovations • facilitating students' ability to comprehend both written and audio-visual materials • encouraging students to improve ideas to eventually produce an oral response and to show expository skills in the oral exam
COURSE CONTENT	• written and audio-visual texts in a variety of fields with a particular focus on art, social science and scientific innovations • strategies and vocabulary exercises which help students improve ideas to produce an oral response and to show required expository skills in the oral exam

COURSEBOOK / MATERIAL / SUGGESTED SOURCES	• **MDB2051 Reading & Speaking Pack** compiled by DML Academic Office • Extra materials and revision exercises prepared by DML Academic Office
Course Learning Outcomes	Students will • be able to identify the main points of the texts and respond them orally after reading a passage and listening to an audio-visual text about the same topic • be aware of topics of discussion in a variety of fields with a particular focus on art, social science and scientific innovations • improve their abilities to comprehend both written and audio-visual texts • be able to improve ideas to eventually produce an oral response and to show expository skills in the oral exam

EVALUATION SYSTEM

Activities	Number	Percentage of Grade
Attendance/Participation	--	
Laboratory	--	
Application	--	
Field Work	--	
Special Course Internship (Work Placement)	--	
Quizzes/Studio Critics	--	
Homework Assignments	--	
Presentations/Jury	--	
Project	--	
Seminar/Workshop	--	
Mid-Term Exams (Written Midterm Exam + Oral Exam)	2	60
Final	1	40
Percentage of In-Term Studies		60
Percentage of Final Examination		40
TOTAL		100

*ECTS WORKLOAD TABLE

Activities	Number	Duration (Hour)	Total Workload
Course Hours	16	2	32
Laboratory	--	--	--
Application	--	--	--
Field Work	--	--	--
Study Hours Out of Class	14	1	14
Special Course Internship (Work Placement)	--	--	--
Homework Assignments	--	--	--
Quizzes/Studio Critics	--	--	--
Project	--	--	--
Presentations / Seminar	--	--	--
Mid-Terms (Examination Duration + Examination Prep. Duration)	2	6	6
Final (Examination Duration + Examination Prep. Duration)	1	5	5
		Total Workload :	57
		Total Workload / 30(h) :	1,90
		ECTS Credit :	2

MDB2051 Reading and Speaking in English 2021-2022 Fall Term Weekly Plan		
WEEKS	**UNITS**	**PROCEDURE**
1 **4-8 October**	**Introduction**	***Introduction to the course*** ***General speaking tips***
2 **11-15 October**	**Unit 1** **Communicating Around the Globe**	***Speaking Practice 1:*** Summarizing orally: Reading and Retelling
3 **18-22 October**	**Unit 2** **21st Century Skills**	***Speaking Practice 2:*** Stating your opinion: Agreeing/Disagreeing
4 **25-29 October** **28 Oct. (half day) OFF + 29 Oct. (full day) OFF**	**Unit 3** **Feeding the World – Can GMOs Help?**	
5 **1-5 November**	**Unit 3** **Feeding the World – Can GMOs Help?**	***Speaking Practice 2:*** Stating your opinion: Agreeing/Disagreeing
6 **8-12 November**	**Unit 4** **The Use of AI in Art**	
7 **15-19 November**	**Unit 4** **The Use of AI in Art**	***Speaking Practice 3:*** Taking a position in a Paired-choice task
8 **22-26 November**		**MIDTERM**
9 **29 Nov.- 3 Dec.**	**Unit 5** **Youth & Activism**	***Oral Exam Input***
10 **6-10 December**	**Unit 5** **Youth & Activism**	***Speaking Practice 4:*** Talking about a personal experience
11 **13-17 December**	**Unit 6** **Volunteer for your world**	***Speaking Practice 5:*** Reporting other people's opinion
12 **20-24 December**		***SPEAKING EXAM***
13 **27-31 December**		***SPEAKING EXAM***
14 **3-7 January**		***SPEAKING EXAM***

MDB ENGLISH COURSES GRADING SCALE

GRADE	LETTER	ECTS
90-100	AA	4.00
80-89	BA	3.50
70-79	BB	3.00
60-69	CB	2.50
53-59	CC	2.00
48-52	DC	1.50
40-47	DD	1.00
30-39	FD	0.50
0-29	FF	0.00
ABSENTEE	F0	0.00

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UNIT I

COMMUNICATING AROUND THE GLOBE

In this unit, you will:

- be introduced a new phenomenon – English as a lingua franca
- watch videos and read a text about the phenomenon
- learn the accommodation strategies for effective global communication
- learn and practice related vocabulary
- practice reading and retelling a text that you have read

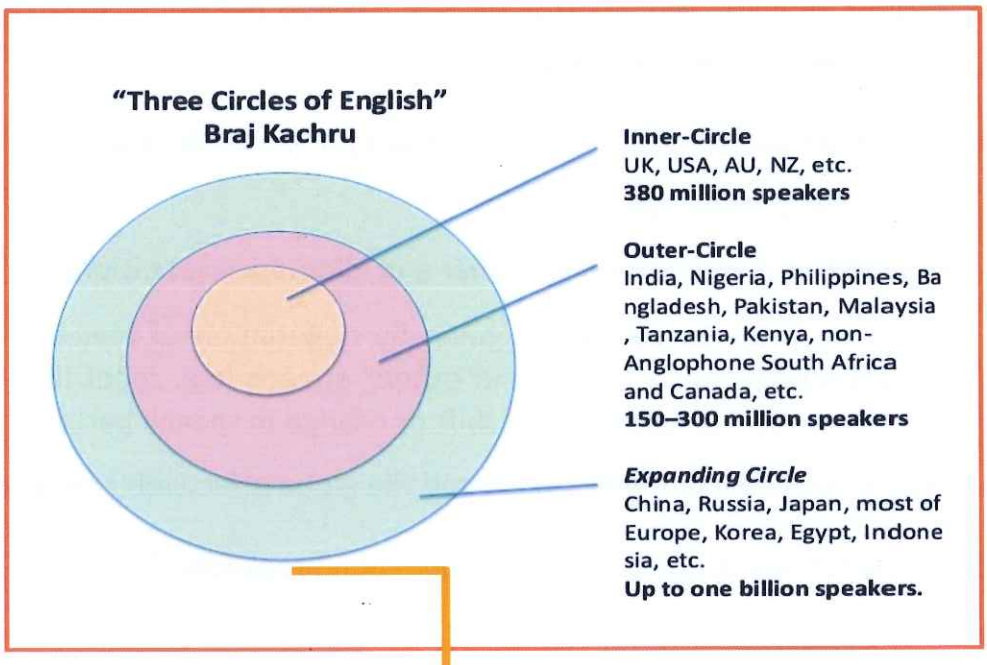
Warm-up

Look at the title of this unit and think about the questions below:

1. What kind of an emphasis does the phrase "around the globe" make in the whole title, *Communicating around the globe*?
2. Which points do you think are most important for successful global communication?
   - native-like pronunciation
   - knowledge of vocabulary, grammar and idiomatic expressions
   - ability to keep conversations going by negotiation of meaning and use of various strategies to understand others' speech (e.g. repetition, paraphrase or code-switching, appropriate shift or change in speech pattern or style)
3. Do you think you can communicate around the globe effectively? Why/Why not?
4. Which of the following can cause communication breakdown?
   - poor pronunciation / strong accent
   - low level of vocabulary
   - lack of knowledge on grammar
   - lack of background knowledge on issues to talk about

Setting the scene

Learning English is not a decision made to communicate with people from English-speaking countries only. English has spread so widely around the world that its native speakers are now outnumbered by its non-native speakers. It is estimated that there are 2 billion (and counting) people learning or speaking English worldwide, and these people are the ones you will probably encounter more frequently in your social, academic and professional life. You'd better get ready to communicate with the ever-growing English speakers of other languages.



Examine Kachru's *Three Circles of English*. Where does "global English" fit in the diagram?

Below is a short text about *English as a lingua franca (ELF)*. Check the questions upon reading the text and discuss:

- what English as a lingua franca is
- why and how ELF has emerged
- in what ways ELF communication may be different
- what makes ELF communication successful

ELF English as a lingua franca refers to the use of English as a common means of communication among people with different mother tongues. Seidlhofer (2011: 7) defines it as "any use of English among speakers of different first languages for whom English is the communicative medium of choice, and often the only option".

For instance; a Danish tourist in Athens asking a Greek passer-by for directions, a French teacher having a conversation with a Spanish colleague during an international conference in Oslo, a group of Italian students chatting with Portuguese and Turkish students via Skype about their eTwinning* programme, German, Chinese and Hungarian co-players sending each other online messages about their team's future strategy in the game all have something in common: they all use English as a lingua franca for communication.

*eTwinning offers a platform for staff (teachers, head teachers, librarians, etc.), working in a school in one of the European countries involved, to communicate, collaborate, develop projects, share and, in short, feel and be part of the most exciting learning community in Europe.

The unprecedented spread of English as a global lingua franca and the fact that native speakers are statistically in a significant minority for language use call for a revision of the role of non-native speakers, who need not be necessarily regarded as English learners and deficient speakers of an interlanguage, but as competent language users and legitimate agents of language change (Brumfit 2001; Brutt-Griffler 2002).

ELF is everywhere; and universities are great places for ELF to develop. Universities all over the world are hosting international students and academic staff and naturally ELF emerges as students and academics with different linguistic backgrounds share the same campus, same academic and social contexts.

Below are some comments by students who carry out conversations with peers from different mother tongues.

- **What points do they make in their comments?**
- **Can you relate to what they think and how they feel?**

"Native speakers of English talk to me sometimes like if I were a native speaker. So sometimes she's like looking the other way, using the phone, talking really soft. And I need higher volume and clarify. Sometimes you need a bit more clear expression, like louder and clearer."

"But with non-native English speakers, we're trying to make ourselves, like be clear, we try to speak in a way that we know that they can get it. It's different, like, you're just talking."

"I don't want to change. I mean, even I know the pronunciation may not be completely correct. I try to change sometimes, but I don't know. Sometimes your tongue just doesn't respond. Sometimes your accent is really difficult to change. And I don't want to always change it. I'm Spanish and this is me."

"Sometimes when non-native speakers of English speak to me, and I'm trying to understand them, I will ask what word they are trying to say. And then only when they explain sometimes what they are trying to say, I tell them, oh, you say it like this, like the pronunciation. We help each other all the time."

"I think it's easier for foreigners, like non-native speaker between non-native, and then when they talk, like bad English, it's not really correct according to native speaker. But we just understand each other because that's how we understand it."

Tips For Effective ELF Communication

#1 Speak English in your own way. Intelligibility is the key!

What is significant about ELF communication is that it takes place among non-native users of English who overwhelmingly exceed the number of native English speakers. That paradigm has changed how English is perceived and has prioritized communication that is intelligible and user competencies such as being able to negotiate meaning rather than having Standard English* as the norm and native speakers as norm providers.

**Standard English: the English that with respect to spelling, grammar, pronunciation, and vocabulary is substantially uniform and well-established in inner circle English-speaking countries.*

Exercise I: Listening

You will listen to three speakers talking about different topics. As you listen, fill in the chart and then answer the questions that follow.

Speaker 1

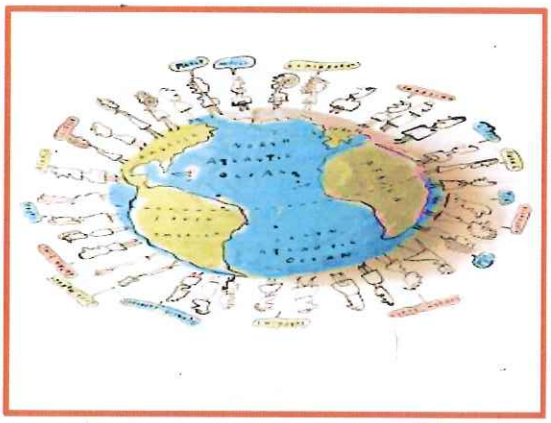
Speaker 2

Speaker 3

Speaker	Speaker's first language is probably...	I can easily follow what the speaker says (Yes/No):	Features of the language the speaker uses:
1			
2			
3			

- Having listened to the speakers, do you think the non-native nuance in how the language is spoken should be considered a *difference* or a *deficit*?
- Do you think one can be a good speaker of a language that is not his/her first language?

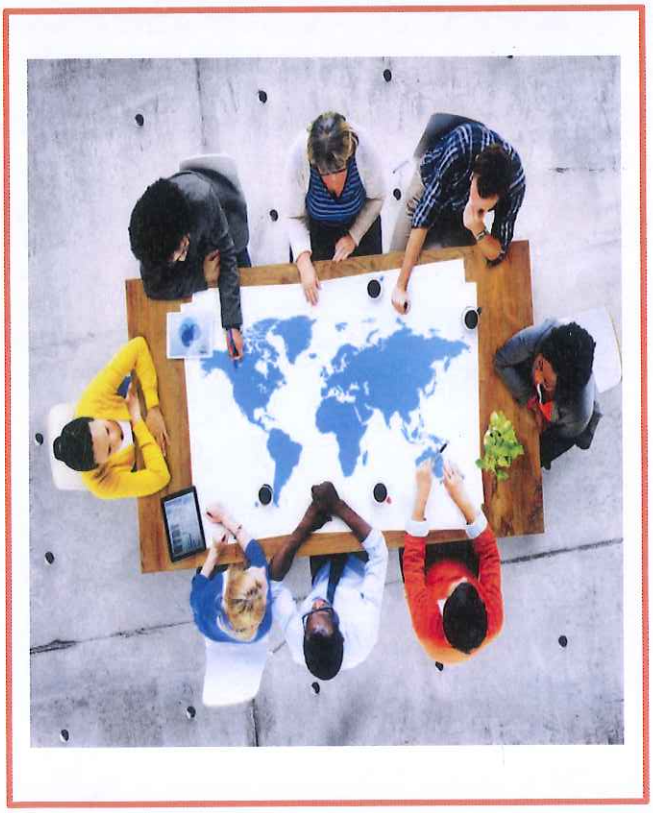
Now, think about the way you speak English. What features do you think exist in how you use the language? Discuss your ideas with your friends.



#2 Language use is fluid and flexible.

Being a competent user of a language requires more than the knowledge of grammar and vocabulary. To be able to fully operate in that language, the speaker should also have the ability to use language effectively in order to achieve a specific purpose and to understand language in context. Language competency also requires that the speaker can variate and adapt his/her language use depending on the context, addressee, time, etc.

Here are some tips to have conversations that flow. Do you think these tips differ from the ones that are necessary for communication in general? Why/Why not?



- Don't be ethnocentric; respect other cultures and peoples
- Be culturally sensitive and aware
- Be aware of non-verbal cues (e.g. gestures)
- Use body language effectively
- Listen, encode and decode carefully
- Think of what the other person will understand before saying
- Get feedback about how you speak and whether you are intelligible
- Avoid slang and local language
- Be open-minded and tolerant
- Be observant
- Be resourceful

#3 It is both the speaker's and listener's job to make conversations flow.

When one fails to do their job, communication breakdowns may occur. At this point, the use of accommodation strategies and conversation tips can serve the purpose of the negotiation of meaning. Accommodation requires adjusting speech to facilitate communication or make one's speech more intelligible (Cogo, 2009). Here are some shortened transcriptions of real ELF conversations where accommodation strategies/conversation tips are used.

Examine the extracts and find out which accommodation strategy is used in each. In which extract do the speaker(s) _____?

a. make a direct comprehension check
b. ask for help when necessary
c. deliver an explanation if they code-switch
d. try different ways of explaining things
e. ask for clarification if they need to

extract 1: _____

Fernanda: How long does it take to get there?
Aiya: Sorry, I couldn't get that.
Fernanda: I mean how much time ...
Aiya: Ah! About two hours.

extract 2: _____

Tuna: It's really, really sweet, because we must keep it for several months. You know, we make it very sweet for its shelf life.
Khan: ...
Tuna: We make it stay fresh for a longer time.
Khan: Oh, I see.

extract 3: a

Jacques: I just forgot to tell you something very important ... we've got full *patronat* ... as we say ... we have full authorization to carry out the project ... by the French president ... by the republic ...

extract 4: f

Isabel: I mean ... we don't have problems ... we all get on well!
Nana: Yeah, I think because we are on the same boat. You understand what I mean?
Isabel: Yes, sure. We are in the same position.

extract 5: c

Dae: ... education minister was accused of plagiarism. He wrote ... wrote and submitted the same topics ... also he borrowed so many results of ... results from his students' dissertations.
Amar: You mean he copied others' work?
Dae: Yes, indeed.

Exercise 2: Maneuvering your language use

Imagine that you are going to take part in the following communication contexts. Would your language use and considerations change in the given contexts? Explain how.

Context 1: You are an Erasmus student in Italy and you are socializing with your friends (from different linguistic backgrounds).

Context 2: You received acceptance for an MA program at Cambridge University in the UK and you are asking a British student questions about the program.

Context 3: You are a university student in your home country. All other students but the teacher share the same mother tongue and you are having an English course where you are discussing the prospects for higher education abroad.

Reading

Vocabulary – Guessing the Meaning

Words alone fall short of making a good guess about their meanings, so we usually need to examine them in context, at least within phrases or parts of sentences where they appear. Below are parts of sentences taken from the text that include new vocabulary items to learn. Examine each of them, and try to guess the meaning of the highlighted words/phrases within the parts of sentences. If you need more contextual cues, please check the text for sentences with highlighted words.

vocabulary items	***your guess***
1. ... found two contradictory meanings in the dictionary	opposed
2. ... the project had flopped, costing hundreds of thousands of dollars	
3. ... didn't reveal the tricky word	
4. ... Ironically, their (native speakers') message is more likely to go astray	
5. ... are happy that English has emerged as the world's global language	
6. ... might not feel the need to accommodate or adapt to the others	
7. ... baffling abbreviations such as 'ooo'	
8. ... it's Anglophones who may need to up their game	
9. ... English is being used as a common denominator	
10. ... having difficulty understanding and conveying messages effectively	
11. ...tuning your ears into a whole range of different ways of using English	
12. ... native speakers of English generally are monolingual and cannot really tackle language variation	

Comprehension Check

Read the text and discuss the questions below:

1. Think about the sentence *"When such misunderstandings happen, it's usually the native speakers who are to blame."*.
    - What does the writer mean by that sentence?
    - What are those misunderstandings?
    - What/Who caused them?
2. How could the native speaker have prevented the misunderstanding?
3. What are the reasons why native English speakers are at a disadvantage in an ELF context?

A MESSAGE GONE WRONG

It was just one word in one email, but it triggered huge financial losses for a multinational company. The message, written in English, was sent by a native speaker to a colleague for whom English was a second language. Unsure of the word, the recipient found two contradictory meanings in his dictionary. He acted on the wrong one.

Months later, senior management investigated why the project had flopped, costing hundreds of thousands of dollars. "It all traced back to this one word," says Chia Suan Chong, a UK-based intercultural communication skills trainer, who didn't reveal the tricky word because it is highly industry-specific and possibly identifiable. "Things spiralled out of control because both parties were thinking the opposite."

When such misunderstandings happen, it's usually the native speakers who are to blame. Ironically, their message is more likely to go astray than that of those who speak English as a second or third language, according to Chong.

"A lot of native speakers are happy that English has emerged as the world's global language. They feel they don't have to spend time learning another language," says Chong. "But often you have a boardroom full of people from different countries communicating in English and all understanding each other and then suddenly the American or Brit walks into the room and nobody can understand them".

The non-native speakers, it turns out, speak more purposefully and carefully, typical of someone speaking a second or third language. Anglophones, on the other hand, often talk too fast for others to follow, and use jokes, slang and references specific to their own culture, says Chong. In emails, they use baffling abbreviations such as 'ooo', instead of simply saying that they will be *out of the office*.

"The native English speaker is the only one who might not feel the need to accommodate or adapt to the others," she adds. With non-native English speakers in the majority worldwide, it's Anglophones who may need to up their game. "Native speakers are at a disadvantage when you are in a lingua franca situation," where English is being used as a common denominator, says Jennifer Jenkins, professor of Global Englishes at the UK's University of Southampton. "It's the native English speakers that are having difficulty understanding and conveying messages effectively."

When trying to communicate in English with a group of people with varying levels of fluency, it's important to be receptive and adaptable, tuning your ears into a whole range of different ways of using English, Jenkins says. "People who've learned other languages are good at doing that, but native speakers of English generally are monolingual and cannot really tackle language variation," she says.

By Lennox Morrison, 2016

Wrapping Up – 5Ws and 1H

Please go over very quickly all the things we have been talking about/discussing so far in this unit and examine the image below. These are the 5Ws and 1H questions asking about English as a lingua franca. Write your own answers for the question words and discuss your answers with your friends.

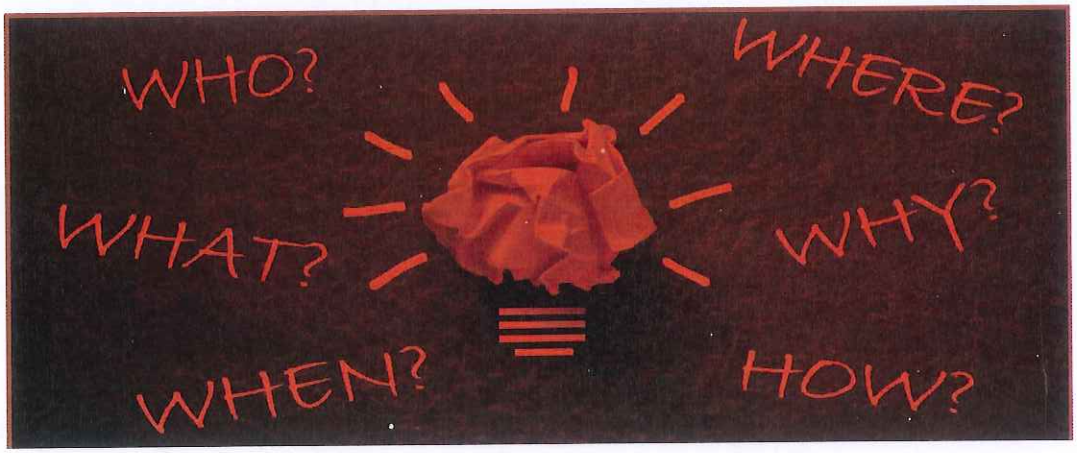
Where? _____

When? _____

Who? _____

How? _____

Why? _____



Speaking Practice 1: Reading and Retelling

Retelling any kind of a text involves a brief synopsis of the text along with the main points of it. It is similar to a summary; however, this method is done orally. Retelling is a higher-level thinking activity because it requires comprehending, analyzing, and synthesizing (Kissner, 2006). Retelling helps readers identify main ideas from a text and use target vocabulary productively.

The texts that we read serve as building blocks to move further and dig deeper in the subject matter, whether it is about environmental crises, art or technology. In other words, they usually set the ground by providing basic information so that readers can understand the subject matter, analyze and evaluate it and eventually form their own perspective towards it. Summarizing orally, in this sense, can be considered as the first step where readers comprehend and internalize what is being discussed/read.

To retell a text properly, readers need to:

- read the text carefully to understand its main idea and purpose
- identify the main points or arguments in the text (in order to exclude details)
- paraphrase to retell a shorter but a more concise version of what has been read

Speaking Task I: Reading and Retelling

In this unit, you have read the text "A Message Gone Wrong". Think about the main idea and purpose of the text and be clear about what to include or exclude in your own version of the text.

Once you are ready, retell the text to your partner and listen to his/her verbal summary. Note that the ideas will overlap; however, there will be differences in how you express yourselves. You can check the student sample below and compare it to yours after you finish your exchange with your partner. Please also note how the student uses some vocabulary from the text in his speech.

This text is about the difficulties people from different linguistic backgrounds may experience during communication and there are some ideas for us to keep in mind to convey messages successfully. English is the denominator today and we should learn how to communicate effectively. In the communication breakdown example, we see that something really bad happens in a company just because people failed to accommodate or adapt to make sure their message is understood correctly. As far as I can understand, accommodation or adaption includes arranging our speaking speed, avoiding culture-specific words, tuning our ears into different accents and making an effort to understand and to be understood. We can always feel baffled and experience such problems, they may be serious or less serious but it is good to know that it is not because of us only, I mean us, the non-native speakers of English! Native speakers also have the responsibility to ensure communication.

Recycling Vocabulary I

Read the unfinished sentences below and complete them so that they are meaningfully consistent with the words/phrases in italics.

1. If things *go astray* while communicating with people from different linguistic backgrounds, set communicating with people right. else

2. They didn't want their start-up to *flop*, _____

3. The weather can be *tricky* in this season. What I mean is that _____

4. There is too much conflicting or *contradictory* information on the net, so one should

5. Our teachers have been trained to use communication strategies to *accommodate* students with hearing disabilities. They can _____

6. She was under interrogation and her *baffling* behaviours such as _____made the police take her into custody.

7. Here are some things you can do to *up your game* while videoconferencing: _____

8. The common *denominator* in relationships are _____
If these are missing, relationships eventually break up.

9. If you want to *convey* your message accurately and effectively, you need to _____

10. A great way to *tune your ears* into different accents in English is _____

References

Brumfit, C.J. (2001). Individual Freedom in Language Teaching: Helping Learners to Develop a Dialect of their Own. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Brutt-Griffler, J. (2002). World English. Clevedon: Multilingual Matters.

Cogo, A. (2009). Accommodating difference in ELF Conversations: A study of pragmatic strategies.

Formentelli, M. (2017). Taking Stance in English as a Lingua Franca: Managing Interpersonal Relations in Academic Lectures. Cambridge Scholars Publishing.

Kachru, B. B. (1985). Standards, codification and sociolinguistic realism: the English language in the outer circle. In R. Quirk, & H. G. Widdowson (Eds.), English in the World: Teaching and Learning the Language and Literatures (pp. 11-30). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Seidlhofer, B. (2011). *Understanding English as a lingua franca.* Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Texts & videos in the unit

http://enrichproject.eu/professional-development/24-english-as-a-lingua-franca
https://www.bbc.com/worklife/article/20161028-native-english-speakers-are-the-worlds-worst-communicators
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yLDK8aKqqSA
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7QV-9N0ybM0&t=42s
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FIL7ZKPPgSc

UNIT 2

21st Century Skills

- In this unit, you will:
- watch a video and read a text about 21st Century Skills
- learn vocabulary related to the topic
- do some vocabulary practice on synonyms
- do some practice on stating your opinion or agreeing/disagreeing with a person/opinion

Warm-up

4Cs?

1. What does "21st century skills" mean to you? Can you name some of them? Communication and creativity
2. Do you think that the acquisition of these skills is important for young people? grammar yes, that's important because when you have to search some [illegible] you can find more information with technology.
3. In what ways can students make use of these skills in their future lives? Students can make communication other stress students

Screening

a. You are going to watch a video about 21st century skills and learn what they are. Before watching the video, have a look at the outline in Part 1 and think about the missing information and then fill in the blanks while watching it.

21st Century Skills

Definition: 21st century skills are 12 abilities that students need to succeed in the age of the internet

1st category: Learning skills (aka the 4 C's)

- Creativity
- critical thinking
- collaboration → iş birliği
- Communication

2nd category: Literary Skills (aka the IMT Skills)

- Information literacy → edebi, yazınsal okuryazarlık
- Media literacy
- technology literacy

3rd category: Life skills (aka the FLIPS)

- flexibility
- leadership
- initiative → girişim
- Social skills

b. Make a critique of the skills outlined above and discuss the following questions in pairs.

1. Which of these categories outweigh the others in importance for future use?
2. Which of these skills are you good at? Which ones do you think need further development to succeed in your academic, professional, and personal life?

1-) I think Learning skills is importance for use, because if you can't collaboration others or communication you can't move in your life

2-) I guess Im good at leadership.

Reading

Before You Read

Before reading the text, have a look at the questions below and discuss your answer with your friends.

1. Do you think that the needs of today's graduates differ from that of the past?
2. What is expected from today's workforce?
3. What do institutions in higher education do to meet the immediate demands of the current workforce?

Vocabulary Study 1: Matching Synonyms

The following sentences are chosen from the text. First check the bold words in the context and guess their meaning without using a dictionary. Then, match the words with the given synonyms.

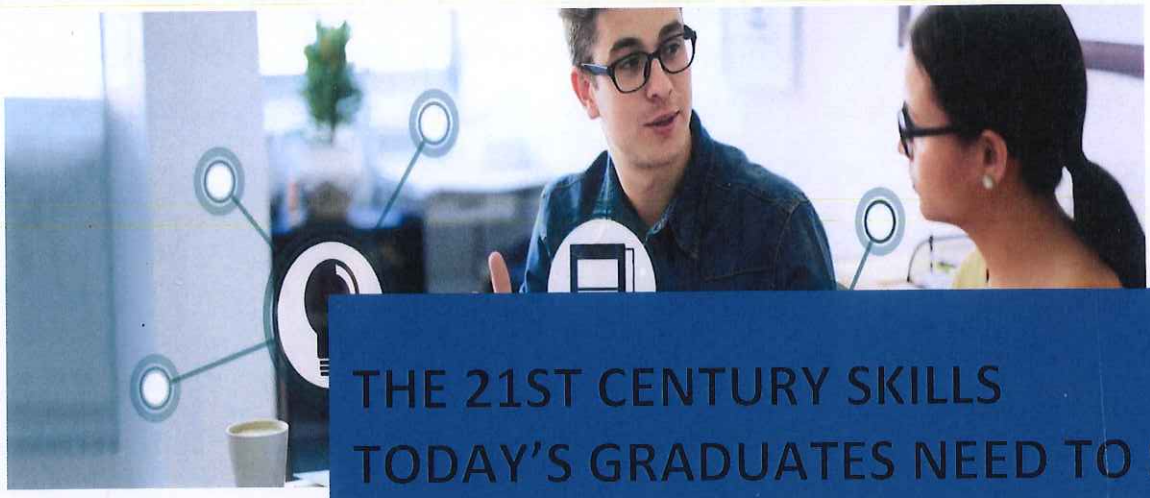
1. This **framework** outlined different skills deemed especially valuable and necessary to prepare today's students for tomorrow's workforce.
2. Numerous states have since joined P21 through the years and have built these 21st century skills into their school districts' **curriculums**.
3. 21st century skills were specifically selected and **deemed** critical to modern workplaces.
4. **Competencies** like communication and collaboration have long been characterized as soft skills and remain important through the evolution into 21st century skills.
5. These are **attributes** that employers are seeking in job candidates.
6. ..., so how can schools **equip** students with these types of 21st century skills without **overhauling** their entire curriculum?

7. Several higher education institutions have **acknowledged** the need to better prepare students for the modern workforce using a more innovative approach.
8. From there, they can add it to their LinkedIn account, website, portfolio, or **resume.**
9. Fortunately, most of the **prominent** institutions are aware of these needs and they are constantly in an up-date in their curriculum to prepare their graduates for the professional world.

Target Words	Synonyms
1. **framework**	a. prepare; qualify
2. **curriculums** müfredat	b. admitted; accepted
3. **deemed** kabul	c. structure; scheme
4. **competencies** yetkinlik	d. re-examining; revising gözden geçirerek
5. **attributes** özellikler	e. regarded as; considered
6. **equip**	f. biography; CV
7. **overhauling** eğitim yenileme	g. important; outstanding
8. **acknowledged** kabul edildi	h. skills; abilities
9. **resume**	i. features; characteristics
10. **prominent** öne çıkan	j. syllabuses; course contents. müfredatlar ders içeriği

initiative → girişim

Read the text below and answer the questions.



THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS TODAY'S GRADUATES NEED TO SUCCEED

by Kristina Ericksen, 2020

A We're in the information age, in which the economy is shaped by technology — a significant departure from manufacturing-focused industrialism. With new innovation comes exciting promise, but also a unique set of challenges for today's graduates. Today, young people need a set of new skills, which has been dubbed "21st century skills", in order to succeed. Thus, it is so important to learn more about 21st century skills and what it means for higher education and work life.

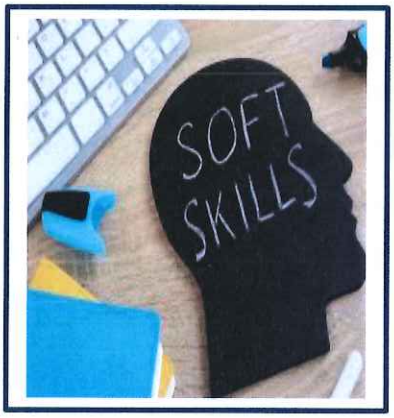
B The 21st century skills movement caught on around the beginning of the millennium, when the National Education Association established the Partnership for 21st Century Skills (P21) and developed a "Framework for 21st Century Learning." This framework outlined different skills deemed especially valuable and necessary to prepare today's students for tomorrow's workforce. Numerous states have since joined P21 through the years and have built these 21st century skills into their school districts' curriculums.

C 21st century skills were specifically selected and deemed critical to modern workplaces. *Advancements in technology have changed not only the type of work that's done, but how it's done.*

Because of this, the human element is growing more important than ever before. This is especially true with emerging technologies, such as machine learning and artificial intelligence. With technology taking on more and more of the repetitive, task-based work, it means that humans are left to tackle more dynamic issues that require creativity, critical thinking and collaboration.

What do employers think of 21st century skills?

D The term "soft skills" is slowly being replaced by "21st century skills." Competencies like communication and collaboration have long been characterized as soft skills and remain important through the evolution into 21st century skills.

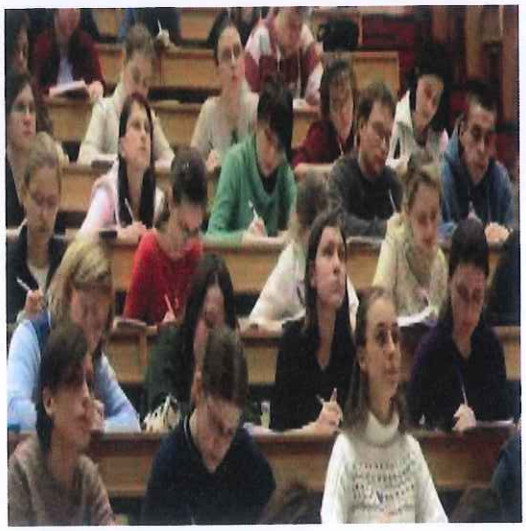


E These are attributes that employers are seeking in job candidates. In fact, a majority of employers find these skills to be just as important as technical skills. In LinkedIn's 2019 Global Talent Trends Report, over 90 percent of surveyed employers reported that soft skills are just as or even more important to hire for than hard skills and in a recent survey of 400 employers, 85 percent reported that they want to hire individuals with a broad range of knowledge and skills, as compared to field-specific skills.

F Unfortunately, only 11 percent of business leaders agree that today's college graduates have the skills needed for today's dynamic workforce. On the other hand, 96 percent of college academic officers believe in their school's ability to prepare students for the workforce. As you can see, there's a disconnection between academia and business world. So, what can be done to connect the needs of employers with the qualifications of college graduates?

What role does higher education play in developing 21st century skills?

G Some universities or particular programs naturally incorporate these kinds of transferable skills into their curriculum. Liberal arts programs, for example, are known for their emphasis on soft skills like leadership, communication, and teamwork. But 21st century skills aren't only valuable for communications or philosophy majors. Even the most technical fields – like computer science or accounting – are in need of professionals who can collaborate, adapt, think critically and take initiative, so how can schools equip students with these types of 21st century skills without overhauling their entire curriculum?



H Several higher education institutions have acknowledged the need to better prepare students for the modern workforce using a more innovative approach. *This* includes new offerings, such as digital badges and micro-credentials, which help arm their graduates with the 21st century skills employers are seeking. Digital badges can cover anything from blogging to time management or even initiative – competencies that until now have not been formally recognized on resumes or LinkedIn profiles. Students earn digital badges in a similar manner to competency-based courses. A digital badge typically contains sub-competencies that are outlined within a rubric, and students must prove their proficiency in the specified skill in order to earn the badge. From there, they can add it to their LinkedIn account, website, portfolio or resume.

I The workforce has evolved, and higher education must follow it. Today's graduates are entering a different type of workforce, so make sure you're setting yours up for success. Fortunately, most of the prominent institutions are aware of these needs and they are constantly in an up-date in their curriculum to prepare their graduates for the professional world.

Comprehension Check

1 According to Par. A, the main difference between the economy of today and the past derives from the fact that manufacturing-focused industrialism with new innovation comes tiredness exciting promise

2 According to Par. B, what is the reason for the curriculum renewal projects in many states?

3 In Par. C, what does the writer mean by saying "Advancements in technology have changed not only the type of work that's done, but how it's done"?

4 The reason why the writer has included some research findings in Par. E is to highlight that _____

5 What is the conflict between the workforce and academia in Par. F?

6 According to Par. G, we can understand that _____.

a. some soft skills are only required for students majoring in art programs

b. education in liberal art programs is rather demanding as it requires mastery in both technical and soft skills

c. soft skills are not that much important for students in technical fields

d. the acquisition of soft skills has utmost importance for students regardless of their disciplines

7 What does "this" refer to in Par. H?

_____

8 According to Par. H, what do students need to do in order to earn a digital badge?

_____

_____

9 According to paragraphs G and H, which of the following cannot be added as a digital badge on one's resume or LinkedIn account?

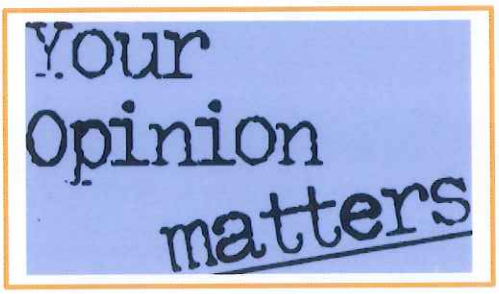
a. Management skills
b. Collaboration skills
c. Organizational skills
d. Technical skills

Speaking Practice 2: Stating your Opinion – Agreeing/Disagreeing

At home, at school and in our social network, we frequently express our opinion about a general topic, an issue, a topic of discussion, etc. Giving opinions as well as agreeing and disagreeing with an idea/person is one of the most common kinds of functional language that we have to produce. In fact, we state opinions whenever we express something "personal", be it a paired-choice, a group discussion or a debate. It is thus important to know how to put our ideas or opinions into words and sound "natural" while speaking.

The three-prong approach to stating your opinion:

- Give your opinion and/or agree or disagree with the prompt
- Explain your opinion by putting forward (at least) two arguments
- Expand your arguments with some support, usually in the form of details, examples or etc.



Example: Studying online is a better way to learn English.

> **(give your opinion)** *To be honest, before studying online, I'd have said no to that. But now that I have done it, in my limited experience I would absolutely agree with the statement.* **(explain your opinion – argument one)** *Above all, technology used in the lessons is an incredible tool to improve your learning and your level.* **(expand your argument one)** *For instance, my teacher records all of our classes which means I can go back and rewatch them if I cannot remember something, if I need some clarification or if I want to listen to my own speaking.* **(explain your opinion – argument two)** *Studying online also made it possible for me to take up some hobbies as I didn't have to leave home for school.* (**expand your argument two)** For instance, *I am doing punch needle embroidery and enjoying it a lot!*

Here are some **structures/useful language** you can make use of while stating your opinion/agreeing/disagreeing. Note that there are a lot more to add to the list; however, what matters is how *clearly* and *naturally* you convey the message rather than how fancy the formulaic language is.

Stating opinion	Agreeing/Partly agreeing	Disagreeing
As far as I am concerned, ... In my (honest/humble) opinion, ... I'd probably/definitely say that ... To be honest, ... Well, actually, ... Personally, ... In my limited/extensive experience, ... It seems to me that ... My impression (on ...) is that ... I have the feeling that ...	I couldn't agree with that more! You're right. / You're absolutely right about that. I feel the same way. That's a good point. I share your view that ... That's just what I was thinking. I feel more or less the same way. I agree with (you) up to a point.	I really don't agree. I don't really agree. (note the difference!) I can see what you/they are trying to say, but ... I understand your/their point of view, but ... I am sorry, but I have to disagree. I am not so sure about that. I take a different view. Yes, but don't you think that ...

Speaking Task 2: Stating your Opinion – Agreeing/Disagreeing

Now, think about the question below and state your opinion using the *three-prong approach.*

Do you think that schools/universities can provide a good ground to develop 21st century skills? Why? Why not?

Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

To be honest I am not sure about universities can provide a good ground. Because you can improve your skills very good with internet. You can find any skills what you develop skills. But of course schools give you a chance to develop your skills but that's not enough I guess,

Vocabulary items in the exercises	More vocabulary items/phrases
framework	changing workforce
curriculum	transformation/evolution of workforce
deem	new job descriptions/demands/ requirements
competencies – yetkinlikler	graduates
attributes – özellikler	prospective/future employees
equip – donatmak	skills/attributes/ qualifications
overhaul – elden geçirme	qualified/proficient/capable employees
acknowledge – bilgi sahibi olmak	acquisition of a skill
resume	(to) acquire/develop/improve a skill
prominent – önemli	(to) be well-equipped for (something)
	(to) equip sb well for (something)
	(to) be highly qualified for (something)

Schools are not give you what you should know

Recycling Vocabulary 2

Part 1: Fill in the blanks by using one of the words given in the table.

framework	resume	deemed
competencies	curriculum	prominent
attributes	equip	overhauled

1. _____ renewal projects aim at revising school programs on a regular basis to make them serve better for the changing needs of students.

2. With the changing demands in workplaces, educators need to update their education schemes in order to curriculum students well for their prospective jobs.

3. Today, academic success is not the mere qualification for a good recruitment after graduation. Graduates need to have some other competencies such as communication, problem solving and high order thinking skills.

4. Within the rising demand in health services in the pandemic, most countries have equip their health care systems or made some siginificant changes in order to provide a better service for their citizens.

5. A behavioral interview is a job interview during which a job applicant is asked to demonstrate his or her knowledge, skills, and abilities, also known as attributes.

6. There is a vacant post for a senior finance director in our company. If you know someone who might be interested in the post, you can forward his/her overhauling by next Monday.

7. Because the prior studies employed similar methods of data collection, it was _____reasonable to compile the data together for the present study.

8. I think this report provides a good framework for further research. We need to conduct all our future work according to the guidelines set in this report.

9. There was a lot of interest for the conference. I think the attendance of some government officials and the most prominent academicians made the event remarkable among the others.

References:

https://collegiseducation.com/news/higher-ed-trends/21st-century-skills/

https://youtu.be/QYfCEnTmr5o

UNIT 3

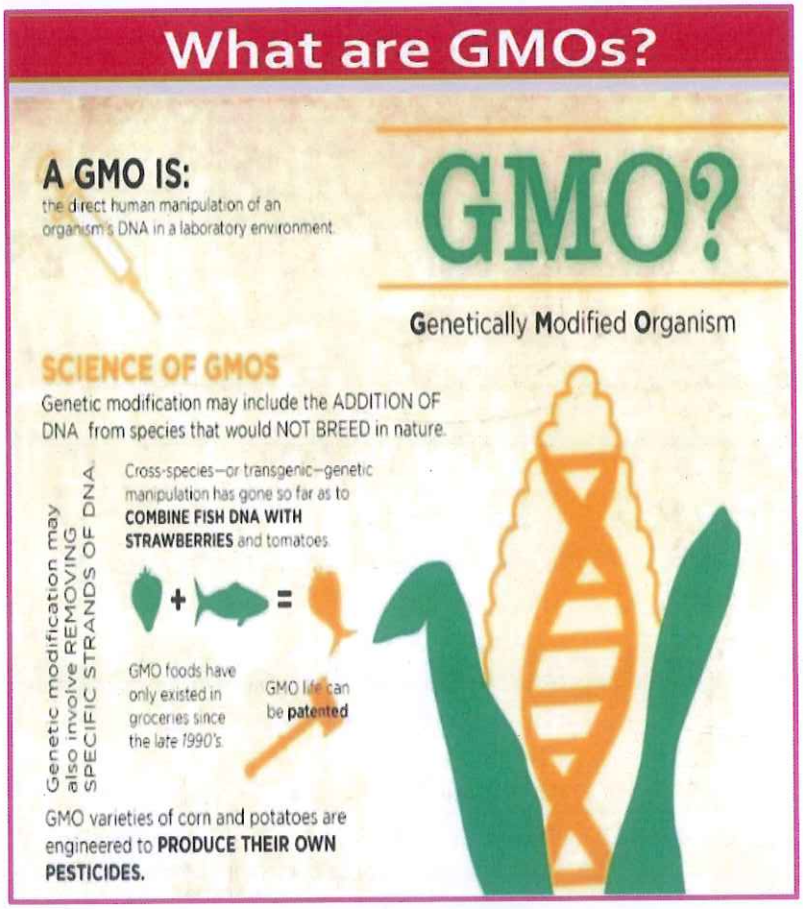
FEEDING THE WORLD – CAN GMOs HELP?

In this unit, you will:

- watch a video and read a text to get information about genetically modified organisms (GMOs)
- do some research about anti-GMO position
- learn and practice vocabulary related to the topic
- do some speaking practice on agreeing and disagreeing with a person/opinion and taking a stand in a discussion

Warm-up

Examine the infographic below and watch the video "What is a genetically modified food?" to think about and discuss the questions on the right.



- If we look at the history of food cultivation, it is apparent that we've been eating genetically modified food all along. What might be the reason for that?
- Is there a difference between how ancient farmers modified food and how foods are modified genetically today?
- Why do you think genetically modified foods have been demonized in recent years by health advocates and environmentalists?

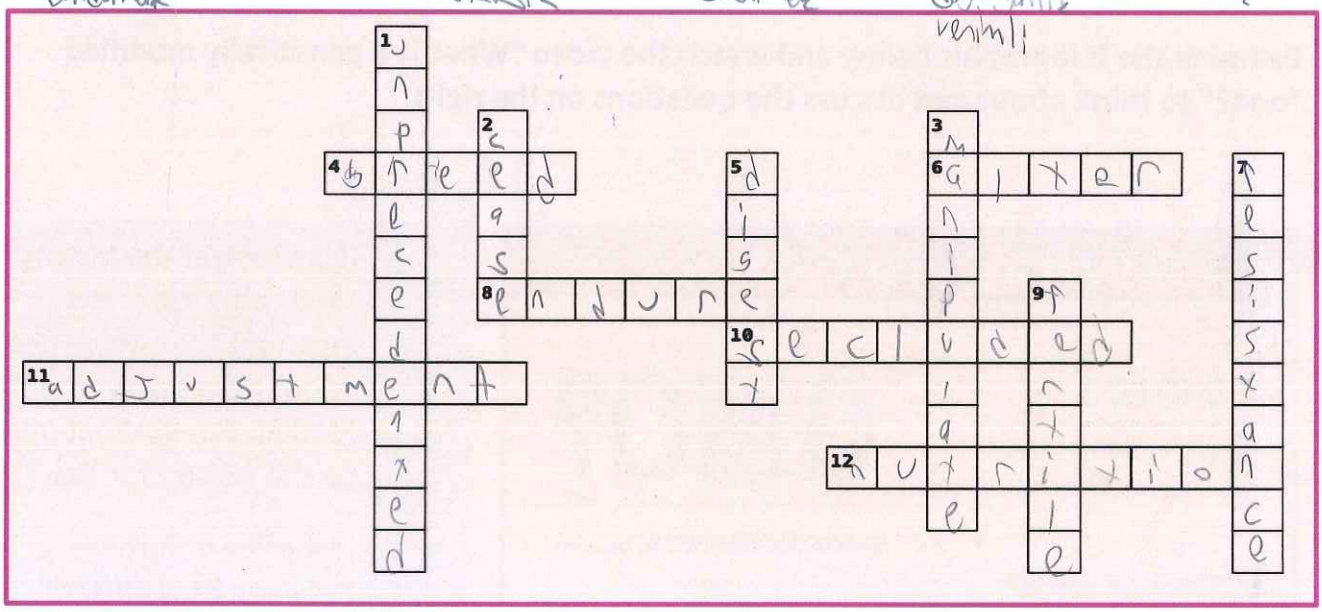
(-) I think there are so many people in the world and ...

Reading

Vocabulary – Replacing Removed Words into Text

Below are some vocabulary items removed from the text that you will read next. First, do the crossword puzzle to find out what the words mean, and then go through the text to replace the removed vocabulary items. You will read the text a second time to do the follow-up questions.

resistance (n)	nutrition (n)	secluded (adj)	adjustment(s) (n)	endure (v)	alter (v)
cease (v)	manipulate (v)	unprecedented (adj)	digest (v)	fertile (adj)	breed(ing) (v)



Across

4. to keep animals or plants for the purpose of producing more of them with particular qualities
6. to make slight changes on something
8. to continue to exist in the same state although it is hard
10. withdrawn from or involving little social activity
11. a small change or movement made to achieve a desired result
12. the process of providing or obtaining the food necessary for health and growth

Down

1. without previous instance; not known or experienced before
2. to stop doing something or to stop happening
3. to manage, or skillfully influence some process of treatment
5. to break down food in the alimentary canal into substances that can be absorbed and used by the body
7. the act of withstanding the force or effect of something
9. producing or capable of producing abundant vegetation or crops

Before You Read

The text below details one side of the debate on genetically modified organisms. Just examining the title can give us an idea about which position the writer takes in the debate:

Is the writer a pro-GMO or an anti-GMO?

Now please read the text carefully and do the exercises that follow.

GMO scientists could save the world from hunger - if we let them

Cutting-edge technology in food production

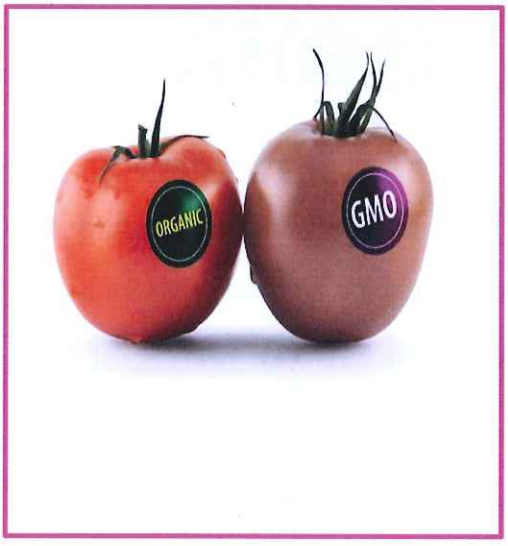
A Experts say global food production will have to double by 2050, at which point the world population is expected to have grown from 7 billion today to well beyond 9 billion. That's just 30 years away, but the problem is: there will be no new **(1)** nutrition land that can be used for agriculture then.

B The solution to feeding *these* people, though, appears to be on the way: In 2012, a new tool was invented, and it has revolutionized how scientists can examine plant genetic processes closely and **(2)** manipulate if necessary.

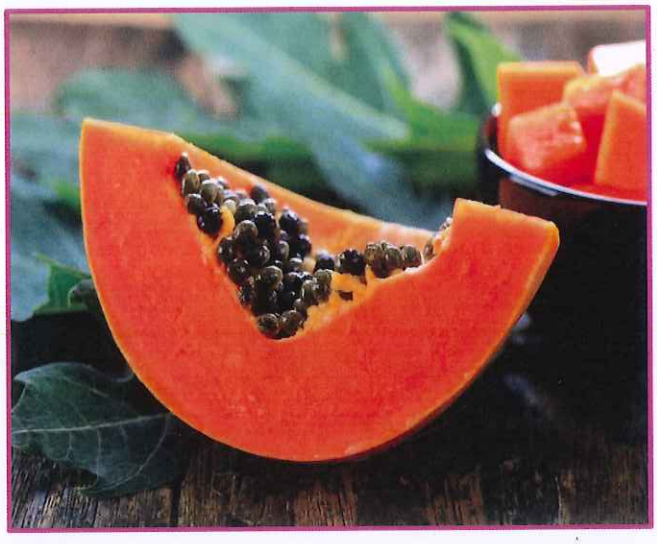
It's called CRISPR-Cas9, and unlike the earlier versions in the world of genetic modification, it is highly specific, allowing scientists to target and **(3)** alter parts of the genome by removing, adding or changing sections of the DNA sequence. Initial signs suggest this tool will be an F-16 jet fighter compared with the Stone Age spear of warfare. That is, the traditional, painstaking means of **(4)** breeding a new plant hybrid will be replaced by the excellence of high-tech agriculture practices. Biologists and geneticists are confident it can help them build a revolution - if we let them.

The merits of CRISPR-Cas9

C The speed and simplicity of CRISPR have momentous implications for agriculture. The process could lead to plants that can **(5)** endure an increasingly overheated and dry nature. It could also result in a more nutritious yield, from less plant. "That's the beauty of the technology", says Joyce Van Eck, the senior researcher at Cornell University's Boyce Thompson Institute, "it can be done for the world in heavily populated and **(6)** secluded communities, for big and small companies, it may, however, be expected that underdeveloped countries welcome the technology in the first place."



D Van Eck and her colleagues have proved that what they already have works smoothly with the tomato. "It is a plant that's *like the white rat in animal studies*," she says. Soon she will be working to improve the tomato's capacity for surviving under undesirable conditions and disease **(7)** resistance, "because we can go in and target exactly the areas we want," she concludes. That promises a future where scientists are able to consider the available inputs - water, soil nutrients, temperature - and make **(8)** adjustment to better control the outputs: productivity, nutritional value, resilience.



Is there a future for GMOs?

E **(i)** In China, the only genetically modified crop currently grown is papaya. **(ii)** However, China's mighty science establishment has grown beyond expectations, with 400 labs and 30,000 researchers. **(iii)** Labs there have already sequenced the genes of 3,000 varieties of rice. **(iv)** In labs, researchers are matching them against one another to find the best traits for **(9)** nutrition, yield and resistance to environmental stressors. **(v)** One result is what researchers have dubbed the "green super rice": a kind of rice, matched with green beans that is now healthier, longer lasting and easier to **(10)** breed even when consumed in large amounts. **(vi)** Even if the Chinese government can't sell genetically modified crops to its own people, there's a good chance the poor populations of Southeast Asia, Africa and India will welcome the nourishment. **(vii)** Gengyun Zhang, head of China's giant genetic engineering center, recently said, "With today's technology, I have no doubt that we can feed the world." **(viii)** Now that the rate of technology is advancing at an **(11)** unprecedented speed, it is likely that feeding world's population will **(12)** _____ to be a major issue in debate agendas. We will need to worry less about feeding the world population.

Comprehension Check

A. What are the arguments that the writer puts forward in favor of GMOs? Please make a list of them below:

_____

_____

_____

_____

B. Choose the best option to answer the questions.

1 Which of the following is NOT TRUE according to paragraphs A and B?

a. Global food production has to increase by 100% to keep up with increasing population.
b. Food production will be a problem as farmable lands are disappearing rapidly.
c. CRISPR-Cas9 offers a promising solution to the potential danger of hunger.
d. Biologists' and geneticists' research on GMOs is receiving support from governments.

2 "*these*" in paragraph B refers to _____.

3 In the comparison between an F-16 jet fighter and the Stone Age spear of warfare, we understand that CRISPR-Cas9 is seen to be _____.

a. the first tool invented for the high-tech agriculture practices
b. powerful enough to find the faulty sequences in DNA
c. a breakthrough to change the existing practices in agriculture
d. in high demand and use in the world of agriculture

4 According to paragraph C, the new technique for rewriting the genome is regarded as "momentous" because it both _____ and _____. (Choose two options)

a. helps plants resist unfavorable climate conditions

b. leads to plants with higher nutritional value

c. relies on the mixing of different-family genes

d. produces massive amounts of nutritious crops

e. serves only for particular countries in the world

5 What does Van Eck mean by "It is a plant that's *like the white rat in animal studies*" in paragraph D?

_____

_____

_____.

6-8 Find sentences in paragraph E that provide evidence for the sentences 6-7 and 8. Write the number of the sentence in paragraph E (i-viii) in the blanks provided.

6 In a lab, researchers have attained a successful outcome when they produced a plant with improved properties.

_____

7 China has massive facilities that can work on GM crops.

_____

8 There are a number of countries in the world which will readily accept to eat GM crops produced in China.

_____

Search & Discuss

The other side of the debate

Now that you have had some information about GMOs, their use and the controversy over their use in practice, it is now time to think about the other side of the debate. As you have listed the arguments of the supporters in the reading text, what kind of counter-arguments do you think opponents may put forth?

Work in groups of three and have a quick search from the internet about why the critics of GMOs argue against the use of them for food production. Here is what you need to do:

- conduct a quick individual search on the net and note down some of the counter-arguments put forth by the opponents of GMOs
- work with your group and discuss all arguments that you have come up with and decide on the ones that you will include in your work as a group for the whole class discussion
- open a shared document (googledocs, padlet, etc.) and post the information you want to share with your classmates so that everyone in class can get a thorough understanding of your no-GMO position

Speaking Task 2: Stating your opinion – Agreeing/Disagreeing with an opinion

Speaking Task for Unit 2

Think about the question below and state your opinion using the *three-prong approach.*
*(You may refer to **Unit 2 Speaking Practice 2** for the speaking practice input)*

Do you think that schools/universities can provide a good ground to develop 21st century skills? Why? Why not?

Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

Vocabulary items in the exercises	More vocabulary items/phrases
deem	changing workforce
curriculum	transformation/evolution of workforce
emerging	new job descriptions/demands/ requirements
competencies	graduates
attributes	prospective/future employees
notorious Löta Söhretti	skills/attributes/ qualifications
equip	qualified/proficient/capable employees
overhaul	acquisition of a skill
acknowledge	(to) acquire/develop/improve a skill
prominent	(to) be well-equipped for
	(to) equip sb well for
	(to) be highly qualified for

Speaking Task for Unit 3

Now that we have the basics of GMOs along with the arguments put forward by both parties; i.e. supporters and opponents, *what would your own position be on the issue?*

Are you an anti-GMO or a pro-GMO?

Take a stand by agreeing or disagreeing with the positions we have discussed. Use the *three-prong approach* to express your opinion. (*You may refer to* ***Unit 2 Speaking Practice 2*** *for the speaking practice input)*

Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

Vocabulary items in the exercises	More vocabulary items/phrases
resistance	food cultivation/production
cease – durdurmak	world population
nutrition – beslenme	genetic modification
manipulate	genetically modified foods/crops
secluded – tenha	traditional/conventional agriculture practices
unprecedented – benzersiz	high-tech agriculture practices
adjustment	developed/underdeveloped countries
digest – sindirmek	breeding plants/hybrid plants
endure – dayanmak	health advocates
fertile – verimlilik	environmentalists çevreciler
alter – değiştirmek	
breed – yaratmak	

Recycling Vocabulary 3

A. Below are some pictures/illustrations for you to examine. Explain what is happening in each picture and write meaningful sentences choosing suitable words from the list. You can make necessary changes while using the words (e.g. word form, opposites, singular/plural)

alter	manipulate	resistance	nutrition	adjustment	cease	fertile

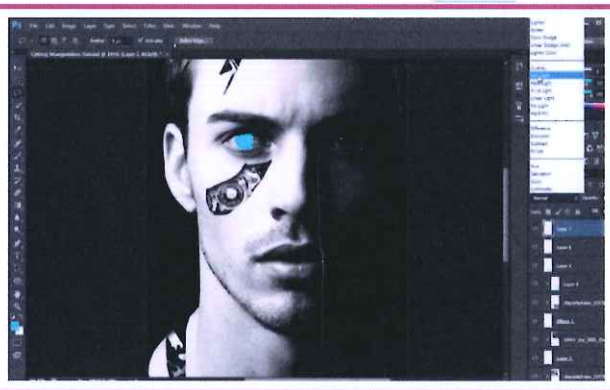
1.

2.

3.

4.

5.



B. Think about the questions below and write your answers in the spaces provided. Make sure to give details for your answers.

1. What do *nutrition experts* recommend for a healthy diet? Do you think GMOs are in their list?

2. Would you accept to eat GMO foods that have been *altered* for greater taste but are probably harmful?

3. Do you think people who live in *secluded* areas need GMOs more than people in populated areas? Why/Why not?

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https://visual.ly/community/Infographics/science/gmo-genetically-modified-organism

https://www.newsweek.com/2015/05/29/gmo-scientists-could-save-world-hunger-if-we-let-them-334119.html

UNIT 4

THE USE OF AI IN ART

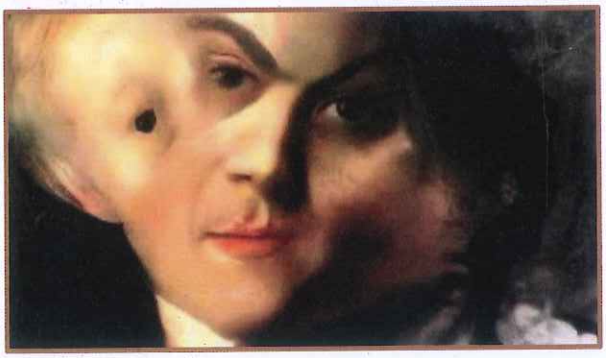
In this unit, you will:

- read a text about "AI generated art"
- learn some vocabulary related to the topic
- do some vocabulary practice on new vocabulary items and prepositional verb phrases.
- do some speaking practice in a paired-choice task

Warm-up

Have a look at the questions below and discuss them in small groups.

- In what domains is artificial intelligence used by people?
- What do you think about its use in art?
- Below are some pictures generated by artificial intelligence. Do you think they are successful pieces of work?
- What do you like/ dislike about them? Why?



Reading

Before You Read

Please have a look at the questions below and discuss them in small groups.

- By checking the title of the text along with the pictures, what do you expect to read in this reading?
- How do you think AI is used in the generation of art?
- Do you think that people value art produced by AI?
- Do you think AI generated art can be considered as "real art"? Why/ Why not?

Screening

Please watch the video "Can AI create real art?" for further information about the topic and for some of the answers of the questions in the warm-up activity.

Vocabulary Part 1: Guessing Word Forms & Matching Synonyms

Check the highlighted words in the text. First, find their word form and then examine them in context to match them with the synonyms given on the right.

Target Word	Word Form	Synonym (a-t)
1. blurred	obscure	vague
2. generate	create	make
3. tweak	adjust	modify
4. auction	public sale	bargain
5. compel	[illegible]	
6. penalize	display	
7. novel	new	innovative
8. showcase	style	category
9. genre	punish	
10. relent	[illegible]	

Synonyms

a. style; category

b. adjust; modify

c. create; make

d. display; exhibit

e. give up; stop resisting

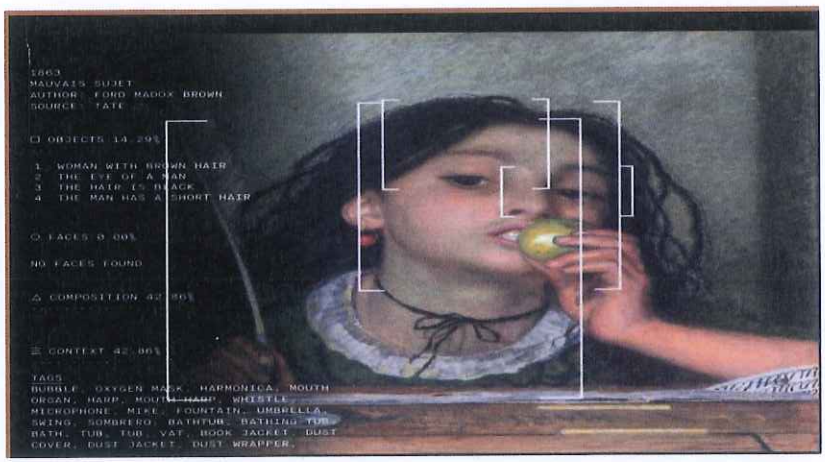
f. new; innovative

g. public sale; bargain

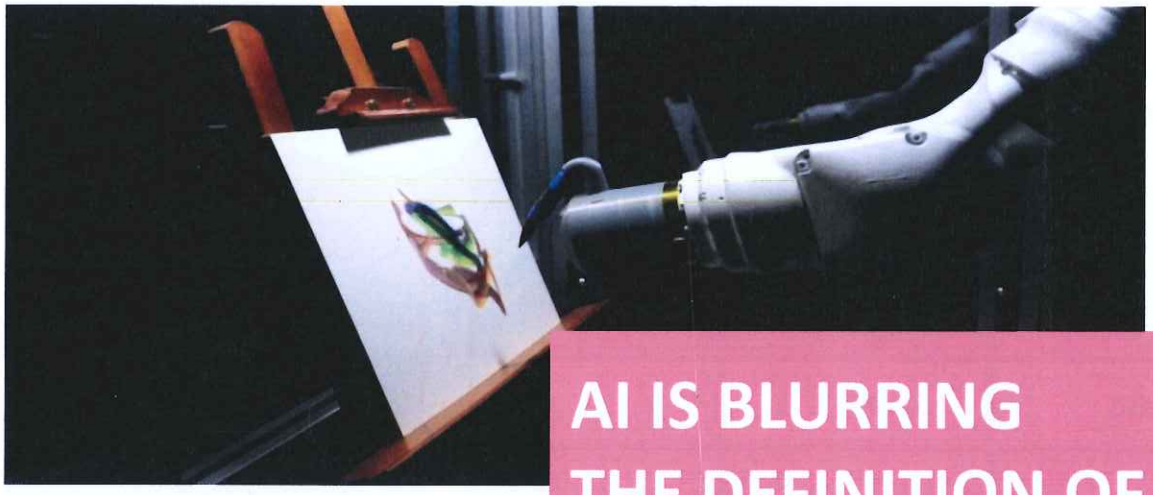
h. force; oblige

i. obscure; vague

j. punish; fine



Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.



AI IS BLURRING THE DEFINITION OF ARTIST

By Ahmed Elgammal

1 With artificial intelligence's (AI) having *incorporated into* more aspects of our daily lives, from writing to driving, it's only natural that artists would also start to *experiment with* it. Indeed, Christie's recently sold its first piece of auctioned AI art—a blurred face titled "Portrait of Edmond Belamy"—for $432,500.

2 The painting is "not the product of a human mind," Christie's noted in its preview. "It was created by artificial intelligence, an algorithm defined by an algebraic formula."

If artificial intelligence is used to create images, can the final product really be thought of as art? Should there be a threshold of influence over the final product that an artist needs to wield?

The Machines Enrol in Art Class

3 To create AI art, artists write algorithms not to follow a set of rules, but to "learn" a specific aesthetic by analysing thousands of images. The algorithm then tries to generate new images in adherence to the aesthetics it has learned.

4 To begin, the artist chooses a collection of images to feed the algorithm, a step I call pre-curation. For example, an artist could feed portraits from the past 500 years into a generative AI algorithm. The algorithms then try to imitate these inputs, producing a range of output images. The artist must *sift through* the output images and select those he or she wishes to use, a step I call post-curation. Throughout this process, the artist maintains an active hand: He or she is very involved in pre-curation and post-curation stages and might also tweak the algorithm as needed to generate the desired outputs.

Meet AICAN

5 But what if a machine were programmed to create art on its own, with little to no human involvement? Our lab has created AICAN (artificial intelligence creative adversarial network), a program that could be thought of as a nearly autonomous artist that has learned existing styles and aesthetics and can generate innovative images of its own. People genuinely like AICAN's work and can't *distinguish* it *from* that of human artists. Its pieces have been exhibited worldwide, and one even recently sold for $16,000 at an auction.

An Emphasis on Novelty

6 When programming AICAN, we used an algorithm called the *creative adversarial network*, which compels AICAN to *contend with* two opposing forces. On one end, it tries to learn the aesthetics of existing works of art. On the other, it will be penalized if, when creating a work of its own, it too closely emulates an established style.

7 At the same time, AICAN *adheres to* what Martindale calls the "least effort" principle, in which he argues that too much novelty will turn off viewers. This careful combination ensures that the art generated will be novel but won't *depart* too far *from* what's considered acceptable. Ideally, it will create something new that builds off what already exists.

Can Humans Tell the Difference?

8 There was still the question of how people would *respond to* AICAN's work. To test this reaction, we showed people AICAN images and works created by human artists that were showcased at Art exhibition in Basel. For each artwork, we asked the participants whether they thought it was made by a machine or an artist. We found that people couldn't tell the difference: Seventy-five percent of the time, they thought the AICAN-generated images had been produced by a human artist.

9 As a scientist, I created the algorithm, but I have no control over what the machine will generate. The machine chooses the genre, the subject, the composition, the colors, and the texture. Though I set the framework, the algorithm is fully at the helm when it comes to the elements and the principles of the art it generates. At the click of a button, the machine creates an image that can then be printed. The works often surprise even me in their range, sophistication, and variation. For this reason, in all exhibitions where the art was shown, I gave credit solely to AICAN for each artwork.

What the Computer cannot Do

10 Still, there's something missing in AICAN's artistic process: The algorithm might create appealing images, but it lives in an isolated creative space that lacks social context. Human artists, on the other hand, are inspired by people, places, and politics. They create art to tell stories and make sense of the world. Of course, just because machines can almost autonomously produce art, it doesn't mean they will replace artists. It simply means that artists will have an additional creative tool at their disposal, one they could even *collaborate with*. AICAN can generate artwork that human curators can then ground in our society and connect to what's happening around us.

11 I often compare AI art to photography. When photography was first invented in the early 19th century, it wasn't considered art—after all, a machine was doing much of the work. The tastemakers resisted, but eventually relented: A century later, photography became an established fine art genre. *I have no doubt that art produced by artificial intelligence will go down the same path.*

Comprehension Check

1 According to paragraphs 1 and 2, what sets "Portrait of Edmond Belamy" apart from other art work is that this portrait is not the product of a human mind, it was created by AI.

2 In paragraph 3, the writer states that the algorithms used by AI artists differ from others because artists write Algorithms not to follow a set rules.

3 In paragraph 4, the steps involved in the generation of AI art can be outlined as:

- The algorithms initiate these inputs
-

4 According to paragraph 5, the distinctive feature that makes AICAN similar to a human artist is that a program that could be thought of as a nearly autonomous artist that has learnt

5 According to paragraph 6, the two opposing functions AICAN needs to fulfill while generating art can be outlined as follows:

On one end it tries to learn the

6 According to paragraph 7, an ideal art work generated by AICAN should combine

7 According to paragraph 8, it can be concluded that

8 In paragraph 9, the writer gives full credit to AICAN as the artist of an artwork because

9 According to paragraph 10, the most important feature that keeps human artists one step ahead of AICAN is that

10 In the last paragraph, what does the writer mean by saying that "*I have no doubt that art produced by artificial intelligence will go down the same path.*"?

Vocabulary Part 2: Guessing Meaning - Prepositional Verbs

Part 1: The following prepositional verbs are chosen from the text. First, check them in the text for their meaning and then, write a synonym for each in the table below.

Par. No	Verb	Preposition	Meaning
Par. 1	incorporate	into	include
Par. 1	experiment	with	try out, test
Par. 4	sift	through	select, eliminates
Par. 5	distinguish	from	pick out
Par. 6	contend	with	deal with, cope with
Par. 7	adhere	to	conform to, stick to
Par. 7	depart	from	diverge, deviate
Par. 8	respond	to	react, act towards
Par.10	collaborate	with	work together, team up

Part 2: Check the following sentences and fill in the blanks by using one of the prepositional verb phrases in Part 1.

1. In order to keep the meeting to the point, we shouldn't depart from the agenda and only discuss the items that are specified in it.

2. I have decided to rent a flat with one of my classmates, but I have some concerns about how my parents will respond to it. I don't know what to do if they oppose to my decision.

3. All drivers must conform to the speed limits. If they violate this rule, this may result in a heavy fine.

4. We need to set off as early as we can. If we leave after 8, I am afraid we will have to contend with rush hour traffic.

5. Before I buy a fully automatic car, I need to experiment with it first. As I am used to driving manual cars, I may find it hard to adapt it.

6. The two paintings are so alike that it is hard to distinguish from them depart from each other. Only an expert can understand which one is real.

7. There are too many tasks to finish. Unless we collaborate with each other, we won't be able to finish them by the deadline.

8. In order to be healthy, one needs to ~~incorporate~~ engage in exercise and good eating habits incorporate into his/her lifestyle.

9. The police will _____ every evidence until they find something important related to the case.

Speaking Practice 3: A Paired-Choice Preference

In a paired-choice task, speakers are presented with two situations or opinions on which they are asked to express their preference and explain why. This task tests a number of speaking abilities including:

- giving opinions
- understanding and responding to questions in the classroom
- participating in discussions
- synthesizing information from two sources
- reporting the opinions of others

TIP 1: Choose your position wisely.

Think about which option you can support easily in the given time.

TIP 2: Create a quick outline.

The words should relate to key points of your response: your choice, two reasons and personal details.

TIP 3: Start by restating the prompt and saying your choice.

For paired choice questions, your topic sentence must include the option you've chosen. You can also combine in the same sentence the restatement and the prompt and your topic sentence (optional).

- *I realize that a lot of people may think differently, but in my opinion...*
- *I know that some people like X, but personally, it's my belief that...*
- *Though some people believe that X is ..., I am of the opinion that Y is ...*
- *While some people may think that X is ..., I believe Y is...*

TIP 4: Provide two key points to support your topic sentence.

Your key points serve to justify the choice you have made. A strong response will include two key points that explain your opinion.

- *There are mainly two reasons why I think/believe that ...*
- *X and Y are the two main reasons for ...*

TIP 5: Use specific details and examples to support each of your key points.

After you state a key point, you should give a personal detail to provide further explanation.

- *For example, ...*
- *For instance, ...*
- *To illustrate, ...*

TIP 6: Make a concluding statement. (optional)

To complete your speech, you may conclude by tying your introductory statement in with the points you have made.

- In conclusion, ...
- In brief/In short, ...
- All in all, ...
- As a whole, what I am trying to say is that ...

Sample Task

Some people believe that successful athletes are born with their talent, while others say that their success comes only through hard work.

Explain which of these arguments you agree with and why. Include details and examples in your explanation.

Sample Outline

Personal Stand: Hard work, not natural ability

- Natural advantages might not be helpful.
  - tall but beaten by shorter players
- It requires hard work.
  - practiced and got better

Sample Speech

I realize that a lot of people may think differently, but in my opinion, successful athletes gain their skills through hard work rather than through natural ability. I hold this opinion for several reasons. First of all, in some cases, natural advantages can work against you. Take me, for example. I play basketball, so it's good that I'm very tall. However, because of my height, I thought that I didn't have to work as hard as shorter people. Imagine my surprise when I played basketball against shorter kids and I lost! It was because I thought my height was all I needed to win, while my shorter opponents worked harder to gain skills. My next reason is that improvement comes through practice. For instance, when I lost against those shorter kids at basketball, it made me want to win, so I started practicing every day, and sure enough, I got better. The next time I played them, I won!

Speaking Task 3: A Paired-Choice Preference

Read the following prompt and prepare your answer by checking the steps outlined above.

Some people believe that AI generated art cannot be considered as real art while others argue just the opposite and give credit to the machines as the artist of an art work.

Which argument do you agree with and why? Make sure to state your choice clearly and include some details in your explanation/response.

Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

Vocabulary items in the exercises		More vocabulary items/phrases
blurred	incorporate into	art/ digital art/ AI-generated art
generate	experiment with	generation/creation of art
tweak	sift through	art tools/ digital tools
auction	distinguish from	art products/ works of art/ art masterpiece(s)
compel	contend with	art exhibition/ gallery/museum
penalize	depart from	make/create/ produce/ perform art
novel	respond to	use/ employ art tools
genre	collaborate with	generate/ produce /create images
showcase		write an algorithm
relent		feed images/input into an algorithm
		exhibit/ display art works
		assess/evaluate/judge the value of art

I think AI generated art is not real art because the others arts are making by people and something. People can create what they want to on paper. So AI art might create art only with people. That's mean AI cannot create or make any art or music something without makers yourselves (people). After all that AI generateds are depended on people And they are work with people. But we can say that Making art by AI is actually made by programmers are writers an algorithm.

Recycling Vocabulary 4

Part 1: Fill in the blanks by using one of the words given in the table.

blurs	genre	penalizes
auction	generate	tweak
compels	relent	novel

1. The company went bankrupt as it failed to _____ sufficient revenue to cover its operating and capital costs.

2. I think the suggestion offered by one of the executives in the board meeting has merit but we need to _____ it a little bit more to make it compatible with our needs.

3. His disregarding of the rules _____ us to take disciplinary action. If he does not behave himself, he may even be dismissed from the company.

4. The wines of these vineyards are sold every year by _____ early in November, and the prices they make serve as standards for the valuation of the other growths.

5. When the journalist didn't _____ and release the name of her source, she was jailed for obstructing justice.

6. The new law _____ the taxpayers who can least afford to pay. Unless some new arrangements are made by the government, they will have hard time to pay for the increased tax values.

7. Science fiction is an interesting _____ that melds real-life science with fantasy elements.

8. Most of the critics have not been satisfied with his performance in his last play. In their reviews, they have highlighted the fact that there is nothing _____ in his latest play and its theme overlaps with some of his previous work.

9. This film _____ the boundary between reality and fantasy. While watching it, you cannot clearly judge which one feeds the other.

Part 2: Read the sentences below and match the underlined parts with the prepositional verb phrases given in the table.

incorporate into	experiment with	sift through
contend with	adhere to	distinguish from
depart from	respond to	collaborate with

1. Neuroscientists are using brain-imaging systems to probe how people **give reaction to** certain stimuli. They study whether these arouse similar feelings in people or not.

_____

2. They will **go through** all the papers in the old trunk, but they are not sure if they will be able to find what they are looking for. _____

3. The board of members have asked us to provide more statistical data in the report. We have assured them that we will evaluate all their suggestions and **include them in** the final version of the report. _____

4. Before submitting your thesis, make sure you **stick to** the checklist provided by the institute for the guidelines to be followed. If your work is not compatible with their suggested layout, you may be asked to revise it. _____

5. Non-fiction is a genre that refers to literature based on fact but written in a creative way that does not **deviate from** what is real. depart from

6. An increasing number of municipalities **work in cooperation with** private technology companies in the spread of smart technologies. This joint work is done in the hope of providing insight into pollution, congestion and waste production in urban areas. collaborate with

7. The lack of social connectivity is something that is difficult to **cope with** when we are working or studying online. Relying merely on virtual meeting platforms does not always help. cope with

8. During the covid-19 pandemic, pharmaceutical companies have made various attempts **to try out** different drugs that would be helpful to eradicate the deadly virus.
experiment with

9. My twin sister and I are so alike that people cannot **separate me from** her when they need to address to us in person. distinguish from

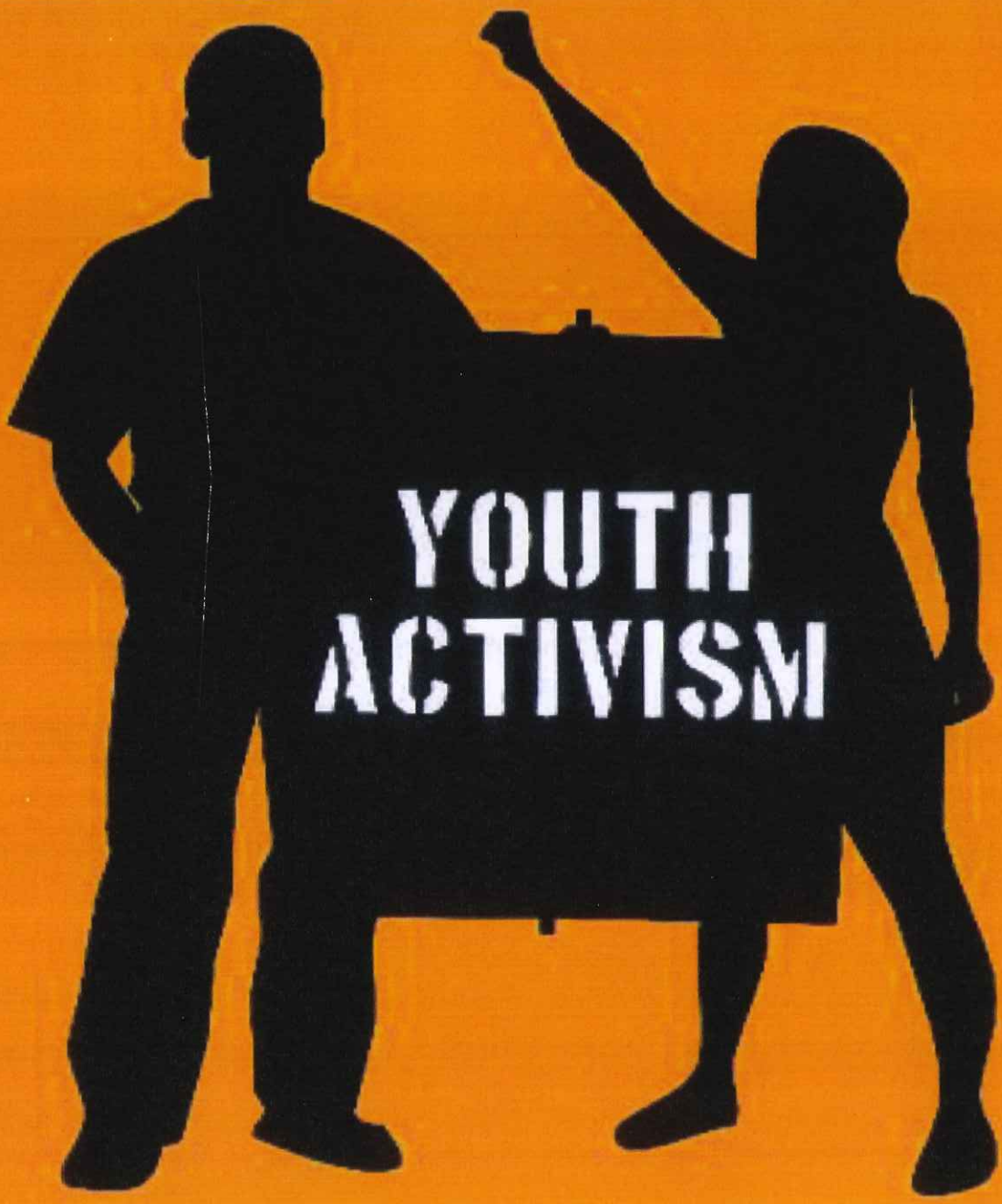
References:

https://www.americanscientist.org/article/ai-is-blurring-the-definition-of-artist

https://youtu.be/_9g5WU3Yhls

(a shorter version of the video is used for the classroom practice)

UNIT 5



Environmental destruction

Animal rights

Social equity

Human rights

Caring for the less fortunate

In this unit, you will:

- watch a video and read a text about youth activism and how it is impactful to make a meaningful change
- learn vocabulary related to the topic "activism"
- guess the meaning of words from the context and do some practice on the vocabulary items chosen from the reading text
- do some speaking practice on talking about a personal experience

WARM-UP

1. Check the title of the unit and the picture on the cover page. What do you expect to read in this unit?
2. What comes to your mind when you think about the words "youth" and "activism" together?
3. Do you think that there is a difference between "youth activism" and "conventional/traditional forms of activism"? If so, what are the main differences between them?
4. What issues do you think the youth is more engaged with nowadays?

Screening

Jennifer Lambert on Generation Z's Activism, Politics and Impact on the Future

You are going to watch an extract taken from the interview with Jennifer Lambert, who outlines Generation Z's Activism and its impact in the future. Before watching the video, have a look at the questions below and then take some notes under each question while watching it.

1.	What descriptor does the reporter use in the introduction of the interview to define Gen Z?
2.	Note down some of the reasons that led Jennifer Lambert to embark on a different career.
3.	What are some of the stereotypes Gen Zers are usually associated with?
4.	What are some of the fundamental characteristics of Gen Zers?
5.	What are some of the issues Gen Zers are usually concerned with?
6.	What tools do they prefer using in their acts?
7.	What effect does technology have on the way they take action and mobilize?
8.	What are some of the movements highlighted in the video for the impact of Gen Z's activism?

Reading

Vocabulary Part 1: Guessing Meaning from Context

The words in Column A have been chosen from the reading text. First check their word form in the context and guess their meaning. Then, match them with the given definitions in Column B.

Column A	Par. No	Word Form	Column B
1. adept (with)	Par. 1	g	a. take collective action
2. revive	Par. 2	l	b. make a joke; make fun of
3. solidarity	Par. 2	f	c. triumph; endeavor
4. mobilize	Par. 4	j	d. employ; make effective use of
5. demonstration	Par. 4	a	e. regain importance or interest
6. utilize	Par. 5	d	f. agreement; shared feeling.
7. fundraise	Par. 7	h	g. proficient in; skilled at
8. revenue	Par. 7	i	h. collect or raise money
9. customizable	Par. 8	k	i. income; earnings
10. prank	Par. 9	b	j. meeting for a cause; protest
11. mount	Par. 10	e	k. adjustable; tailor-made
12. feat	Par. 10	c	l. go up; increase

Before You Read

A. Check the following questions below and have a quick discussion about them in pairs.

1. By checking the title and the pictures in the text, what aspects of online activism might be covered in the scope of this text?
2. Do you think that young activists can bring about some real changes in society via online activism? Why/Why not?

B. The following sub-titles are removed from the reading below. Skim through the text and put them into correct place in the text.

a. Action and Awareness

b. Petitions for Change

c. Generation Z's Innovation

d. How Generation Z is Increasing Foreign Aid

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

ONLINE ACTIVISM: HOW GenZ IS MAKING CHANGE

by Jacquelyn Burrer

1. Generation Z has grown up in a time of endless war, online activism and extreme cultural change. With unlimited access to the internet, many Zoomers have become adept with technology. They often use the internet to self-educate on important topics and become more globalized people. Generation Z has channeled their frustration in society into online activism, creating an international movement of social awareness.

_____

2. Gen Z has grown up with online activism. Teenagers care about making a difference in a way that is accessible to them. A campaign from 2015 that revived in 2019 involved turning a person's Instagram profile picture into blue in solidarity with the Sudan protests. It brought attention to the fact that the Sudan military opened fire on unarmed demonstrators and killed over 100 people. One of the demonstrators who died, Mohammad Mattar, had a blue image as his profile picture. The *#BlueForSudan* trend started in honor of him and the protests. Turning Instagram profile pictures into blue increased awareness and encouraged many young people to educate themselves on the situation.

3. Most Zoomers use various kinds of social media platforms, but one of the best platforms to reach millions is TikTok. Posting a graphic on an Instagram story with a small platform frequently reaches hundreds. However, on TikTok, 100 followers could easily make a video go viral. Teens have figured out that by commenting, pressing the "copy link" button and rewatching the video, the TikTok algorithm will give more attention to the video, hence increasing its audience. This knowledge allows Zoomers to make any video go viral to inform millions of people.

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4. Similarly, Gen Z has also found that it can mobilize and overtake certain hashtags. For example, the recent *#blackoutTuesday* demonstration led to the creation of over 20 million posts in a day to show solidarity with the *Black Lives Matter* movement. As the most technologically advanced generation, Gen Z can easily operate through online activism to create change.

5. Gen Z members have also begun to utilize scripted emails to quickly contact their representatives in support of specific causes. A pre-written email in the U.K. has become popular to show support in ending the Yemen crisis. The Borgen Project and many other organizations have noticed this effective way to create meaningful change in government and have provided an assortment of scripted emails for citizens to send to their representatives.

6. Another popular way of spreading awareness about important issues is through the repost button on Instagram. Instagram stories are a popular way to spread information to many people. It is now very efficient to share important news with your followers with minimal work.

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7. Generation Z comprises of teenagers and college students. Therefore, most Zoomers do not have the funds to donate directly and have found alternative ways to fundraise. The most common way to do this is through YouTube ads. Creators put ads on their videos to generate revenue for donations. One hour-long video that the account "haera shin" created was to collect donations for Save the Children, a humanitarian organization helping end the Yemen crisis.

8. Zoomers also popularized Cardd.co links: free links to spread resources on a customizable single-page website. Most have links to resources to learn more about the topic, petitions to sign, how to contact your representatives and other information to know. One Yemen Cardd.co is incredibly popular and has reached a significant number of people as Zoomers continue to link the Cardd.co in their Instagram, Twitter, and other social media bios.

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9. Zoomers have popularized using petitions to create awareness and have even created a new internet trend meant to increase petition signatures. They are using a character called Manny, from the book series "Diary of a Wimpy Kid," as a reminder to sign a petition. For example, whenever a drawing of Manny pops up on one's social media feed, it is a prompt to sign a petition. The Manny character first arose in an attempt to prank Fox News. It featured a petition to change the American flag to what Zoomers call the "Manny flag." The petition started as a joke, but it created a reminder that gets thousands of Zoomers to sign petitions hourly.

10. Most petitions that people are signing at the moment are in relation to Black Lives Matter or the Yemen crisis. As petitions gain attention and signatures increase, pressure mounts on leaders to take action. By participating in online activism, teenagers are helping change the world without a single click, a feat no other generation has accomplished before.

Comprehension Check

1. According to Par. 1, how does Gen Z reflect their concern or discontent about social issues?

   _____

2. According to Par. 2, the members of Gen Z changed their Instagram profile pictures into blue to show that _____

3. What was the underlying cause for the Sudan protests?

   _____

4. According to paragraph 3, the underlying reason why most Gen Zers prefer sharing their content on TikTok rather than Instagram is that _____

   _____

5. The reason why teenagers make use of scripted e-mails as in the case of Yemen is to _____

6. Since they can't make their own living, Gen Zers usually raise money to support for their cause _____

7. By using Card.co links, teenagers aim at _____

   _____

8. According to Par. 9, the "Manny flag" appearing on one's feed is a reminder of

   _____

9. According to Par.10, Gen Zers are trying to increase the number of signatures on petitions because _____

   _____

Vocabulary Part 2 – Using Collocations

Your understanding of the texts partly depends on your understanding of the key words that are recycled throughout the text. Pay special attention to these key words and any examples used in the text to help you understand them.

Check the following words that are recycled throughout the text, *Online Activism: How Gen Z is making a Change* and think about the words that can be used or collocate with them. You can check the text for reference, or you can find and add any other alternative words/chunks that you think are relevant to the topic "activism".

1. _____ (social) awareness
2. _____ attention (to something)
3. _____ a difference/change (in something)
4. _____ posts/comments/views (on one's platform)
5. _____ support (for a cause)
6. _____ information/news/resources (on a platform)
7. _____ donations
8. _____ petitions
9. _____ signatures
10. _____ pressure (on somebody)

INPUT ON SPEAKING EXAM

About the Speaking Exam

- During the last 3 weeks of the fall term, you will take an oral exam that will be evaluated and graded as your midterm.
- You need to take the exam on the exact date assigned by your instructor. Please consult your instructor if you need to take the exam on another date for a valid reason (like reported illness or any case of emergency provided that it is proven).
- The oral exam will test your ability to display the speaking skills that have been improved in class throughout the term.
- The oral exam questions will be on the texts and/or audio-visual materials covered in class throughout the term, and on the extensive reading texts that you are required to study on your own.
- You will respond to two questions. One of the questions will be about one of the texts covered in class and the other one will be about one of the extensive reading topics that you are assigned to study on your own. Once you pick your questions, you will not be able to change them.
- You will have a few minutes to examine the questions in order to plan your responses. You can take notes if you need to; however, you will not be allowed to do any kind of research from any kind of printed or electronic resource.
- You are expected to speak for about 2-3 minutes on each question you have picked.
- Your responses will be graded according to the Oral Exam Grading Criteria on the following page.
- Your oral exam results will be announced at the end of the term before the final exam.

ORAL EXAM GRADING CRITERIA

CONTENT 20%	
15-20	Evidence of excellent knowledge of the topics; can speak without the need for teacher intervention; fully satisfying the purpose of the task set, can handle questions of the instructor in a proficient way. Excellent ability to conceptualize knowledge. Demonstrates inventive thinking and synthesis abilities.
10-14	Evidence of good and appropriate knowledge of the topics; can speak according to the purpose but needs to be guided by the questions of the instructor. Good ability to conceptualize knowledge and demonstrate inventive thinking. Comprehensive synthesis of course materials.
5-9	Adequate preparation; task requirements mostly fulfilled; can hardly speak according to the purpose, can only answer a few of the instructor's questions. Some ability to conceptualize knowledge. Demonstrates moderate inventive thinking and synthesis abilities.
0-4	Lack of knowledge of the topics; task requirements not fulfilled; cannot speak to the purpose, cannot handle the instructor's questions competently. Limited ability to conceptualize knowledge. Does not demonstrate inventive thinking or synthesis abilities.
CLASS PARTICIPATION 20%	
13-20	Not only participated in but also actively contributed to the speaking activities.
7-12	Demonstrated interest and actively participated in the speaking activities.
0-6	Demonstrated no interest in speaking activities and was silent most of the time.
LANGUAGE, COMPREHENSIBILITY 20%	
15-20	Very accurate language; comprehensible responses; excellent communication of ideas; excellent use of grammar & advanced structures. Can move from one idea to another smoothly while talking.
10-14	Generally accurate language; responses mostly comprehensible; speaker struggled for appropriate vocabulary. Good communication of ideas. Adequate vocabulary for the task; moderate usage of grammar and advanced structures. Limited logical sequence.
5-9	Frequent inaccurate use of language and responses rarely comprehensible. Moderate communication of ideas. Limited vocabulary which proves to be inadequate for the task, makes mistakes even in basic grammatical structures; lacks logical sequence.
0-4	Use of language, vocabulary and grammar insufficient and responses incomprehensible. Cannot speak with ease, unable to link ideas together, cannot make a good beginning and an ending.
VOCABULARY 20%	
15-20	Varied and highly sophisticated vocabulary; can make an excellent use of the vocabulary learned in class.
10-14	Adequate and accurate use of vocabulary to ensure powerful expression.
5-9	Somewhat inadequate and inaccurate use of vocabulary; mostly repetitive.
0-4	Inadequate and inaccurate use of vocabulary.

DELIVERY, FLUENCY AND PRONUNCIATION 20%	
15-20	Can speak fast and very fluently with very few halts when searching for appropriate words and expressions, clear and accurate pronunciation.
10-14	Speech at a moderate speed and can be followed; some pronunciation difficulties not interfering with understanding.
5-9	Speech rather slow and hesitant or too fast and monotonous, making the speech difficult to follow; many pronunciation difficulties interfering with understanding.
0-4	Inappropriate pronunciation, lack of fluency, speech too slow to follow.

Speaking Practice 4: Talking about a Personal Experience

Talking about personal experiences is among the most common speaking tasks that test-takers perform in internationally recognized English-language tests. Here are some useful tips and strategies with a sample to help you organize your own speech for the task on personal experiences.

Sample prompt:

Describe an online campaign that inspired you. Include details and examples to support your explanation.

Tip 1: Create a quick outline during the preparation time. Just quickly write down a few words. The words should relate to key points of your response: your topic sentence, two examples or reasons to support it and personal details. By noting in outline form just the key words of your response, you will have an idea of how you will organize your response while speaking.

Sample Outline

Restatement of the Prompt: An online campaign that inspired me: ALS Ice Bucket Challenge

Topic Sentence: Influenced me for a couple of reasons

Key Point 1: Reached masses

Personal Details: Raised awareness

Key Point 2: Encouraged me to start my own campaign

Personal Details: My campaign on street animals

Tip 2: Analyze the prompt and create a topic sentence. By analyzing the prompt, you'll know what information you need to give in an effective response. In your response, rephrasing the prompt and stating your opinion demonstrates that you understand the basic topic. Use signposts like the ones in the table below to tell your listeners what you'll be talking about.

Signposts: Giving Reasons and/or Explanations
There are two main reasons for ...
The two reasons that I have for ... are ... and ...
... inspires me in several ways, including...
I feel this way for a couple of different reasons.
I enjoy/ don't enjoy ... for a couple of reasons.
There are a couple of reasons why I think / it is important ...

Sample Restatement of the Prompt:

ALS Ice Bucket Challenge was an online campaign that really inspired me.

Sample Topic Sentence:

There are a couple of reasons why I was influenced by this campaign.

Tip 3: Provide at least two key points to support your topic sentence. In order to support your topic sentence, you must discuss at least two key points that explain and reinforce your topic sentence. Make sure your two key points are very different from each other. Include any of the following signposts to introduce your key points.

Signposts: Offering Key Supporting Points
For one thing... / For the other ...
My first reason for thinking this way is that ...
First ... / Second... / Next ...
First of all / Secondly, ...
To begin with/ To start with ...
My second/ third/ next reason is that ...
Another reason that I think important is that...
Additionally/ Furthermore/ Moreover/ What is more/ Also, ...

Sample Key Point 1: *For one thing, the campaign reached masses.*

Sample Key Point 2: *Secondly, the campaign encouraged me to start my own campaign.*

Tip 4: Use specific details and examples to support each of your key points. After you state a key point, you should give a personal detail to provide further explanation. A good way to add personal details is to give examples but make sure that your examples and details are relevant to the prompt. Keep in mind that a personal detail might also be a further explanation and does not necessarily need to be an example.

Signposts: Giving Examples
For example, ... / For instance, ...
Take XX for example .. / Here is an example of ...
Let me give you an example of ...
And here's another example of ...
... like/such as/ including ...

Sample Personal Detail 1:

Even famous people like Bill Gates and Mark Zuckerberg contributed to raising awareness on the illness ALS.

Sample Personal Detail 2:

Inspired by the great impact this campaign had, I thought I could raise awareness about street animals and started my own online campaign.

Listen to a sample student response

ALS Ice Bucket Challenge was a campaign that really inspired me. There are a couple of reasons why I was influenced by that campaign. For one thing, the campaign reached masses. Even famous people like Bill Gates and Mark Zuckerberg contributed to raising awareness on the illness ALS. Secondly, the campaign encouraged me to start my own campaign. Inspired by the great impact this campaign had, I thought I could raise awareness about street animals and started my own online campaign.

Speaking Task 4: Talking about a personal experience

Think about the online movements led by the youth in Turkey and decide on one which served for its purpose and paved the way for a meaningful change.

Give detailed information about the movement including its aim, scope, means of tools and result. Make sure to include some details and relevant support to show its implications for the public.

Work in groups and prepare a group task for the prompt above. Make sure to follow the steps outlined above while doing your task. Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

Vocabulary items in the exercises	More vocabulary items/phrases
adept with ...ste	online/digital activism
revive canlandırmak	social/political/environmental issues
solidarity dayanışma	individual acts/ collective acts
mobilize harekettirilik	online movements/demonstrations/protests
demonstration gösteri	(to) take online action
utilize faydalanmak	(to) support for a cause
fundraise bağış	(to) organize grassroot movements/protests
revenue gelir	(to) share/spread news/information
customizable gelistirilebilir	(to) raise /create awareness
prank şaka	(to) attract attention to an issue
mount dayanak	(to) mobilize
feat başarı, ustalık	(to) make a collective effort/ (to) struggle
	(to) make one's voice heard
	(to) make/bring about a change

The following outline would be of your help while preparing your task:

The name of the online movement:	
Restatement of the prompt	
Topic Sentence	
Key Point 1	
Personal Details/ Support for Point 1	
Key Point 2	
Personal Details/ Support for Point 2	

Recycling Vocabulary 5

Part 1: Fill in the blanks by using one of the words given in the table.

adept with	demonstration	mobilize
revived	revenue	utilize
solidarity	fundraise	pranks
feat	customizable	mounted

1. A government's _____ and expenditure should be balanced. If there is a gap between these two, it may find itself in an inevitable economic crisis.
2. Opponents of the new law are planning to hold a big _____ in front of the parliament to protest the new legislation.
3. As young people are more _____ technological devices as a result of using them all the time, they can easily get used to new digital practices. They can more easily keep up with the innovations in technology compared to older generations.
4. Since there is a problem with the consumption of existing natural resources, we need to _____ them attentively. Unless we take some immediate measures and find some alternative ways, we are doomed to run out of them in the future.
5. Teenagers usually prefer online movements to _____ support for a cause they are concerned with. They believe that they can reach a lot of people easily in this way and induce more people to take action.
6. The pandemic has _____ the interest towards the integration of technology into classroom practices. As education has been moved to digital platforms due to the pandemic restrictions, educators all around the world have developed an interest into this topic to deliver more effective online courses.

7. During the protests, some drivers honked their horns to show their _____ with the peace marchers.

8. The CV templates on the net would be of great help for new graduates. As all these templates are _____ they can easily tailor the required parts to make it compatible with their needs.

9. The disputes among two managers over company policies _____ the tension during the board meeting yesterday. If the chairman had not soothed the both sides and invited them to negotiation, it could have turned into a worse situation.

10. He led his team to victory for the tenth time, a _____ no captain had achieved before.

11. A person who _____ others enjoys playing tricks that are intended for fun but not aiming at giving any harm or damage.

12. After the earthquake, the non-governmental organizations started to _____ to provide aid for the survivors in the disaster area.

Part 2: Check the phrases in italics and complete the sentences in a meaningful way.

1. If you a *make a donation* for a cause, _____
   _____
2. If you *give support for* a cause, _____
   _____
3. If you *show your solidarity* for a cause, _____
   _____
4. If you have *social awareness* for an issue, _____
   _____
5. If you sign a petition online, _____
   _____

References:

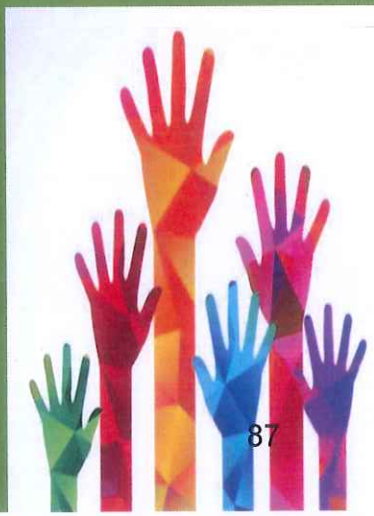
https://borgenproject.org/online-activism/

https://youtu.be/9m8lgAGznbk

(a shorter version of the video is used for the classroom practice)

UNIT 6

VOLUNTEER FOR YOUR WORLD



In this unit, you will:

- learn the cruciality of the carbon footprint
- get some practical suggestions about how to lead an environmentally-friendly life
- watch a video on adopting sustainable lifestyle habits
- learn and practice vocabulary related to the topic
- do some practice on reporting others' opinions and elaborating on quotes

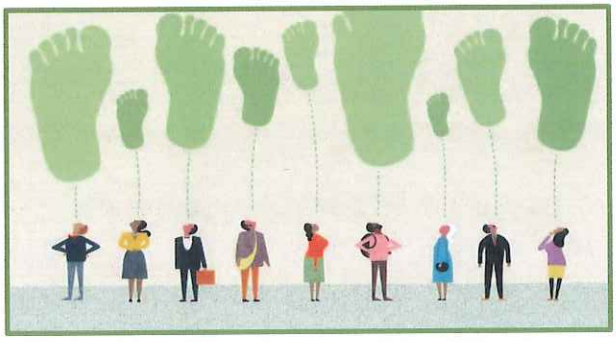
Warm-up

Think about the questions below and then read the short information about the carbon footprint.

- Have you ever heard about the term "carbon footprint"?
- What activities do you think affect a person's carbon footprint?
- Do you think people in different countries/continents produce different amounts of carbon footprint? Why?

regard as → olarak görmek

The Carbon Footprint



A carbon footprint is the total amount of greenhouse gas emissions that come from the production, use and end-of-life of a product or service. It includes carbon dioxide – the gas most commonly emitted by humans – and others, including methane, nitrous oxide, and fluorinated gases, which trap heat in the atmosphere, causing global warming.

The carbon footprint has global, national, societal and individual contributors. The size of a person's carbon footprint depends on lifestyle choices, such as transportation, diet and purchases. When thinking about your own carbon footprint, you need to consider how many miles you travel by car, bus, train and plane, the energy usage in your home, how much you shop, and the composition of your diet.

The Carbon Footprint Questionnaire

Think about your daily routines, lifestyle and consumption habits and take the questionnaire below to tally your carbon footprint. After completing the questionnaire and finding out your result, compare your score with that of your friends and check who scored the highest/lowest in class.

1. How do you get to school?
a. walk/bike (0)
b. car (1115)
c. bus (131)
d. carpool (459)

2. Do you eat mostly...
a. fast food (4818)
b. home-cooked food (62)

3. Do you eat mostly...
a. vegetables/fruits (153)
b. meat (644)
c. bread, rice, pasta, potatoes (364)

4. Do you turn off lights when you leave a room?
a. yes (133)
b. no (268)

5. Do you unplug appliances/chargers when they are not in use?
a. yes (9)
b. no (18)

6. How do you dry clothes?
a. hang to dry (0)
b. use a dryer (750)
c. both (375)

7. Do you turn off the water when brushing your teeth?
a. yes (34)
b. no (274)

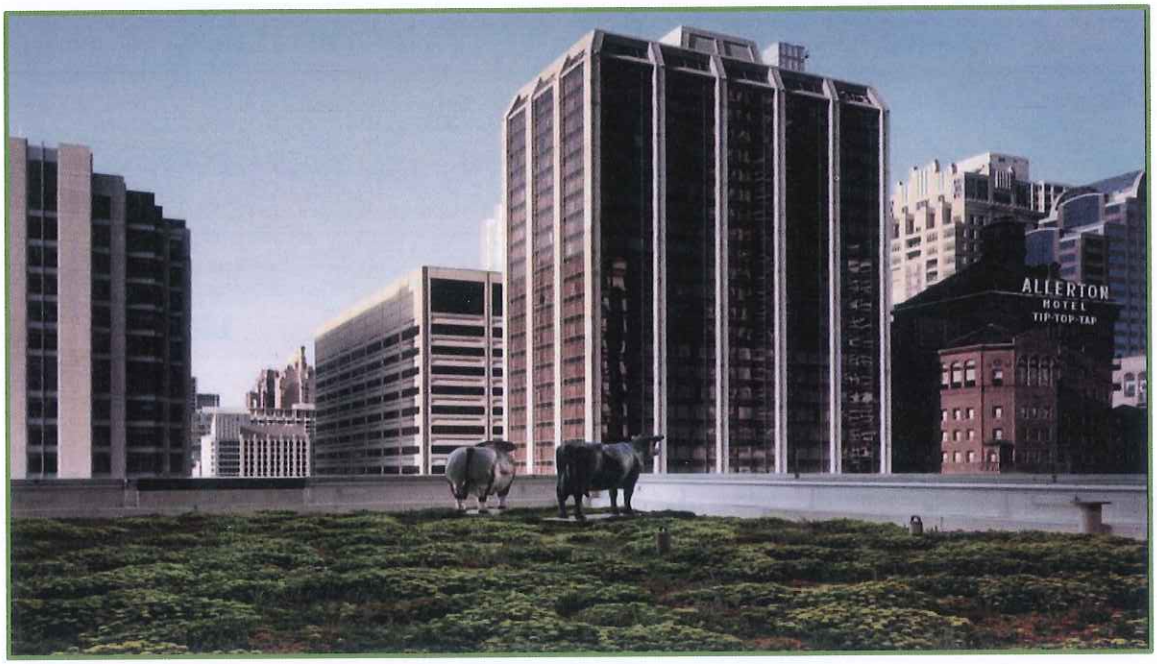
8. Do you turn off the TV when you're not watching it?
a. yes (47)
b. no (140)

9. Do you turn off your video game system when you're not using it?
a. yes (29)
b. no (90)
c. don't have/use one (0)

10. Do you recycle? Select all that apply.
a. magazines (-15)
b. newspaper (-90)
c. glass (-7)
d. plastic (-19)
e. aluminium and steel cans (-89)

The total is an estimate of your carbon footprint and shows the number of pounds of carbon dioxide you produce annually. The lower the number is, the fewer greenhouse gasses are emitted into the atmosphere.

Your total score: _____



Reading

Feeling guilty because you have scored high on the questionnaire? Below are the 7 basic suggestions you – as an individual – can adopt to lower your carbon footprint and help save our planet.

Read the text and think about how you would complete the sentences below.

Of the 7 suggestions I have read for a better world, ...

- ***these are the things I have already been doing:***

_____

_____

_____.

- ***these are the things I haven't done (yet):***

_____

_____

_____.

- ***the ones that seem very easy to do are:***

_____

_____

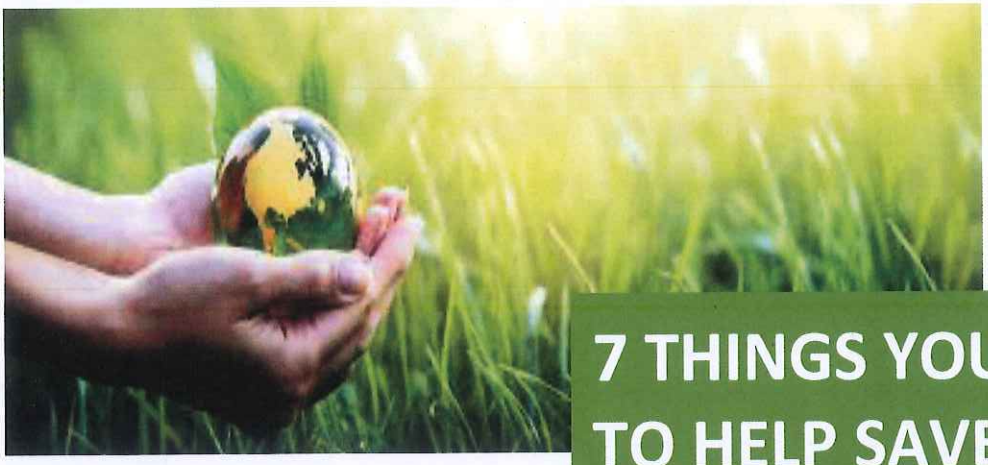
_____.

- ***the ones that seem very difficult to do are:***

_____

_____

_____.



7 THINGS YOU CAN DO TO HELP SAVE OUR PLANET

#1 Use your voice

We are not the first generation to know we're destroying the world, but we could be the last that can do anything about it. Speaking up is one of the most powerful things you can do especially if it's to the right people. Contact the brands you buy from and get them to tell you how their products are sourced. For instance, use social media, which is one of the most effective ways to get brands to listen to you, and tell them that you want a change. It's not just about speaking to the people in charge. Talk to your friends, neighbors and colleagues and get them to make positive changes, too. Speak up, speak to everyone, and make your voice heard.

#2 Be Informed

One of the best things you can do is to keep yourself informed because the more you know, the better it is. It leaves you better equipped to have those conversations with your friends and family, and the people you want to influence. Get yourself clued up on the facts, stay up to date with recent news on the state of our natural world and work out what you can do. We have the world at our fingertips, so learn from influential people, keep up with the news and research organisations that are working to make our planet a better place.

#3 Travel Responsibly

One of the most efficient ways of lowering your environmental impact is by travelling responsibly. This means, whenever you can, choosing a more sustainable way to get from A to B - walk or cycle when you can. Transport is one of the most polluting services in the world. However, holidaying closer to home may make a big impact on your carbon footprint. One short-haul return flight can account for 10% of your yearly carbon emissions, and long-haul flights can severely affect your carbon impact. If you have the time, you can usually get trains to certain destinations to cut your carbon footprint. Get creative and try to find alternative ways to travel. If you are looking to see the local wildlife, consider going about it ethically. Attractions involving petting, holding or feeding animals for money are generally a no-go. As a rule: observe or watch animals from afar in their natural habitat and look for ways to support local conservation projects.

#4 Eat sustainably

Food production is a major driver of wildlife extinction. What we eat contributes around a quarter of global greenhouse gas emissions and is responsible for almost 60% of global biodiversity loss. Farming animals for meat and dairy requires space and huge inputs of water and feed. Today, one of the biggest causes of forest loss is the expansion of agricultural land for animal feed production such as soy, and producing meat creates vastly more carbon dioxide than plants such as vegetables, grains and legumes. Moving away from a meat-dominated diet towards a more plant-based diet can lower your impact on the environment. Vegetarian and vegan foods are massively on the rise and becoming far more common in restaurants, cafes and supermarkets, so you'll rarely struggle. Not only that, but also cutting down on meat and dairy products can reduce your weekly food bills.

#5 Reduce your waste

Wasting our resources should be considered unacceptable in all aspects of our life. Every product we buy has an environmental footprint and could end up in landfill. The impact of plastic pollution on our oceans is becoming increasingly clear, having drastic impacts on marine life. Recycling what we can reduces the number of new materials we are making, and upcycling is a creative way to make old items into something more valuable. This could be reusing a jam jar as a candle holder, or using old tins as plant pots – the possibilities are endless! It's not just the products we buy. It's estimated that a third of all food produced in the world is lost or wasted. Do your bit by eating up leftovers and use any ingredients you have spare to make interesting meals. Try to waste as little food as possible, and compost the organic waste you can't eat.

#6 Watch what you buy

We can all do more to be more conscious about what we buy, and where we buy from. Buying less will save you money, reduce waste and improve your environmental footprint. Leading a less consumerist lifestyle can benefit you and our planet. Use your purchasing power and make sure your money is going towards positive change. By supporting eco-friendly products which are less damaging to the environment, you're encouraging companies to source and produce their products in a sustainable way.

#7 Volunteer for your world

Volunteering can be daunting, and confusing if you don't know where to look. Yet it doesn't need to be this hard to lend a hand. Often local nature reserves or parks are looking for regular volunteers, which can give you practical conservation experience as well as helping to restore nature your local area. There are networks of youth internship schemes across the world where you can work on a placement with a non-governmental organization such as WWF or Greenpeace. Supporters worldwide are helping non-governmental organizations to restore nature and tackle the main causes of nature's decline. These organizations rely on generous donations to carry out our projects all around the world. There are lots of ways to give. Become a member of those, adopt an animal, take on a challenge or encourage your family and friends to donate. It's an exciting opportunity to be able to work in the front line of nature conservation.

Vocabulary Part: Multi-word verbs

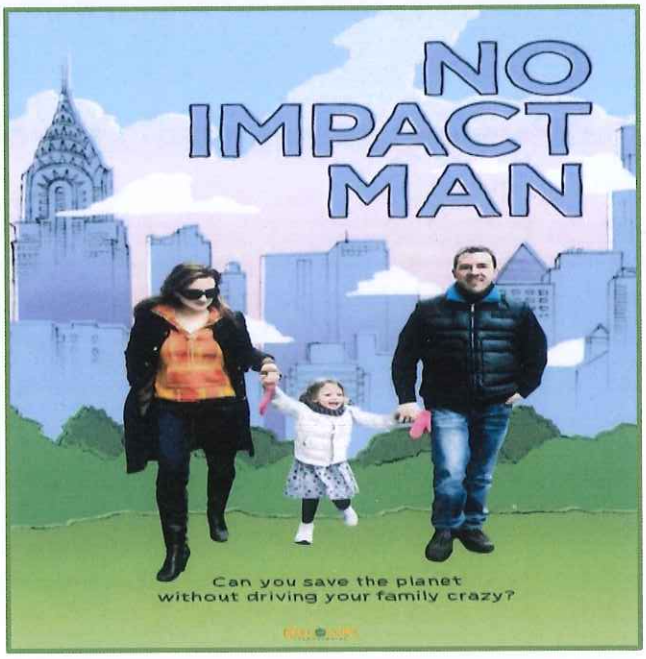
A multi-word verb is a group of words used together, which is usually in the form of a combination with a verb and a noun/adjective/prepositional phrase. Phrasal verbs (verb+ one/two preposition(s), and idiomatic expressions (verb + a noun/adjective phrase with a preposition) are the common examples of multi-word phrases.

Go through the text and check the underlined multi-word verbs in each paragraph and then look for contextual clues to guess their meaning. When you are done, discuss your ideas with your classmates.

multi-word verbs	***synonyms/definitions***
1. speak up konuşmak	talk up
2. be/get clued up bilgilenmek	be informed
3. stay up to date güncel kalmak	
4. work out üzerinde çalışmak	solve
5. keep up with takip etmek	follow
6. go about gitt	wander
7. move away from uzaklaşmak	walk away
8. cut down on kısmak	throttle
9. end up sonuçlanmak	finish
10. eat up yiyip bitirmek	demolish
11. lend a hand el uzatmak	give a hand
12. take on üstlenmek	accept

Exercise 2: Video - No Impact Man

You will watch the trailer of the documentary *No Impact Man*. It tells the story of the author Colin Beavan, who went completely "green," giving up virtually all of the comforts of modern living -- electricity, gas-powered transportation, shipped food and public waste disposal -- in a drastic effort to curb his environmental impact. The cameras capture the toll as this well-intentioned, year-long project takes on Beavan's wife and baby daughter, as well as the ways it brings this family closer together.



Watch and discuss:

- What kind of changes has the family made to have "no impact" on the environment?
- Do you think you can adopt those changes in your own lifestyle? Which lifestyle changes are more difficult/easier for you?
- What would happen if people all around the world adopted such a lifestyle? What would the world/life be like?
- Do you think the "no impact" lifestyle is a sustainable one? Explain why.

- Colin Beavan asks a probing question in the trailer:

Is it possible to have a good life without wasting so much?

What do you think? Do you think it is possible?

Speaking Practice 5: Reporting Other People's Opinions

In some speaking tasks, you will be asked to report what other people say in the texts you read, audio tracks you listen to or videos you watch. To fulfil such a task, you need to convey the person's message (to your audience) thoroughly in an objective manner, paying extra attention to include the main points he/she makes. Then, you may agree or disagree with the person, telling the reasons why you think so.

Sample task and planning your response:

"Grades do not encourage students to learn" said *the protagonist in the book The Little Prince*.

Report the quote by paraphrasing the original statement and state if you agree or disagree. Support your explanation with details and examples.

Step 1: Report the quote in your own words (by paraphrasing the main points in the statement)
Step 2: Explain what the statement means or what you understand from the statement.
Step 3: Tell whether you agree or disagree with the idea
Step 4: Present your first reason and expand it with some support (i.e. relevant examples and details)
Step 5: Present your second reason and explain it with some support (i.e. relevant examples and details)
Step 6: Conclude your speech restating your own point of view (optional)

Sample speech:

In the quotation, it is suggested that the grades we get do not have an effect on our learning. Personally, though, I believe that grades encourage students to study and boost learning. I feel this way for two reasons. For one thing, grades motivate students to take their studies seriously. For example, during my sophomore year, I had to complete a major assignment in a political science class. The assignment would make up about half of my total grade in the class, so I approached my work with diligence and care. I wrote a compelling speech and spent hours preparing for every possible question my classmates could think of. If the presentation had not been graded, I would not have prepared so much for it. Secondly, grades motivate students because they clearly demonstrate which students in a class are the best and brightest. When I took a graded class in my junior year, I spent hours in the library researching my papers so that I could show my professors that I was intellectually superior to my classmates. Well, this may appear somewhat shallow, but in today's competitive academic environment, it is absolutely necessary for students to distinguish themselves.

Speaking Task 5: Reporting Other People's Opinions

Now think about the three quotations below and choose one of them. Report the quote by paraphrasing the original statement and state if you agree or disagree. Support your explanation with details and examples.

Quote 1: "Be the change you wish to see in the world." ***Mahatma Gandhi***

Quote 2: "We can change the world and make it a better place. It is in your hands to make a difference." ***Nelson Mandela***

Quote 3: "The Earth is a fine place and is worth fighting for." ***Ernest Hemingway***

Do not forget to make use of the useful structures and upgrade your speech with new vocabulary you learned in this unit. Below you can find the list of vocabulary items introduced in this unit and an additional list of more words and phrases that you may wish to use in your speech.

Vocabulary items in the exercises	More vocabulary items/phrases
speak up be/get clued up stay up to date work out keep up with go about move away from cut down on end up eat up lend a hand take on	volunteering carbon footprint greenhouse effect contributor/contributing agent/contributing factor consume/consumer/consumption consumption habits lifestyle choices sustainable lifestyle leading/adopting a sustainable/green lifestyle lowering/increasing one's environmental impact biodiversity loss wildlife extinction meat-dominated/plant-based diet eco-friendly products

Recycling Vocabulary 6

Read the sentences and rewrite them using appropriate multi-word verbs in the list below. The underlined parts of the sentences will help you decide which multi-word verb should be used in each sentence.

a. stay up to date	b. go about	c. end up	d. be/get clued up	e. eat up	f. lend a hand
g. move away from	h. speak up	i. work out	j. cut down on	k. take on	l. keep up with

1. The investments we have made in the post sales department are paying off. We have had 60% less customer complaints so far.

_____

2. She is the one who has a lot of information about the latest developments in computer technology. I ask for her assistance whenever I need it.

_____

3. Studying at graduate programs is a tough decision to make. You should know that you need to invest a lot of time and effort into this process.

_____

4. Using a credit card is easy and comfortable but you may eventually get into trouble if you do not watch your spending carefully.

_____

5. Young people have to make their voices heard if they want real change. Otherwise, nobody will care about what they are struggling with.

---

6. People are becoming more conscious about how they live. They are trying to do more of what makes them happy and relaxed and less of what causes stress in their lives.

---

7. The board of directors are holding a meeting at the moment in order to come up with a solution to the crisis which broke out in the corporation. It is hoped that they will come up with a brilliant plan.

References

https://www.nytimes.com/spotlight/guides

https://agsci.oregonstate.edu/sites/agscid7/files/carbon_footprint_5.23.2017.pdf

https://coppellcommunitygarden.org/event/documentary-no-impact-man/

https://www.wwf.org.uk/thingsyoucando

EXTENSIVE READINGS

EXTENSIVE READING 1

'Kids are the best teachers': Why Maritza Morales Casanova believes children are the answer to climate change

As young children, most of us don't know what we want to be when we grow up. Not Maritza Morales Casanova.

Morales Casanova grew up in Mexico's Yucatán Peninsula. An area of rich and vibrant biodiversity, it's home to more than 7,300 animal species and over 2,300 plant varieties, some of which are found only here and nowhere else. However, the Yucatán ecosystem is threatened by land clearance for farming.

Having witnessed the loss and degradation of natural areas, Morales Casanova committed her life to protecting her home and inspiring others on the issue, too. In 1995, at the age of 10, she founded HUNAB, an environmental advocacy group that promotes peer-to-peer learning.

25 years on, HUNAB is going strong and its reach has grown. In 2013, Morales Casanova opened the Ceiba Pentandra education center in the outskirts of Merida, the capital of Yucatán. It provides space and resources for children to learn about the environment, and share their knowledge with classmates.

CNN spoke to Morales Casanova to find out more about her work with aspiring environmentalists, and why children are vital in solving the climate crisis.
This interview has been edited and condensed for clarity.

CNN: What inspired you to start HUNAB?

Maritza Morales Casanova: When I was a child, there were no places where I could learn more about nature and environmental sciences. That's why I decided to start a project to share this information with my peers. Often, scientific information is not so easy to understand,and I translate that information for kids so that families can have fun at the same time as having a beautiful experience learning about and observing nature. I want to inspire them to change their lifestyles and live in harmony with the environment.

CNN: What does your education center, Ceiba Pentandra, offer?

M.M.C.: We educate kids who come to HUNAB and they stay for at least three years learning how to be heroes for Grandma Earth. They learn things about the water cycle, the medical properties of plants, how to cultivate food, and how to create compost. They get an accreditation to be environmental instructors. Most of them spend about eight years here and take on their own environmental project to protect nature and the environment. We work with them to achieve a goal in conservation.

CNN: How many kids do you educate?

M.M.C.: In 25 years of activity, we have involved more than 50,000 people in Yucatán. Currently, we have more than 10,000 students in 300 communities replicating and learning our activities.

CNN: Why is positive messaging so important?

M.M.C.: Information about the environment is very alarming and negative around the world. What we need is inspiration: a positive message to take action. That's especially important for young kids and new generations. We cannot teach climate change and just scare kids. If our kids grow with a positive message, they will have a strong heart to take action. We are cultivating new environmental leaders from childhood.

CNN: Why is educating children about the environment so important?

M.M.C.: What I have learned is that we cannot know what kids are going to be when they grow up. But I'm sure that if they have the right knowledge, if they have the right values from childhood, then in a few years, they could be governors, politicians, entrepreneurs, where they have the power to make decisions that respect all living beings.

CNN: Why do children make the best teachers?

M.M.C.: They can share knowledge and feelings with the same language. Sometimes, adults have different worries or concerns, but you can see how honest kids are and also how they can inspire others to take action. I have noticed that adults are sometimes selfish about knowledge: we don't often want to share it, or we want to keep it to make money and profits. But when kids gain knowledge, first they try to understand the message for themselves, and then share it in a simple way.

CNN: What are your hopes for the future of HUNAB?

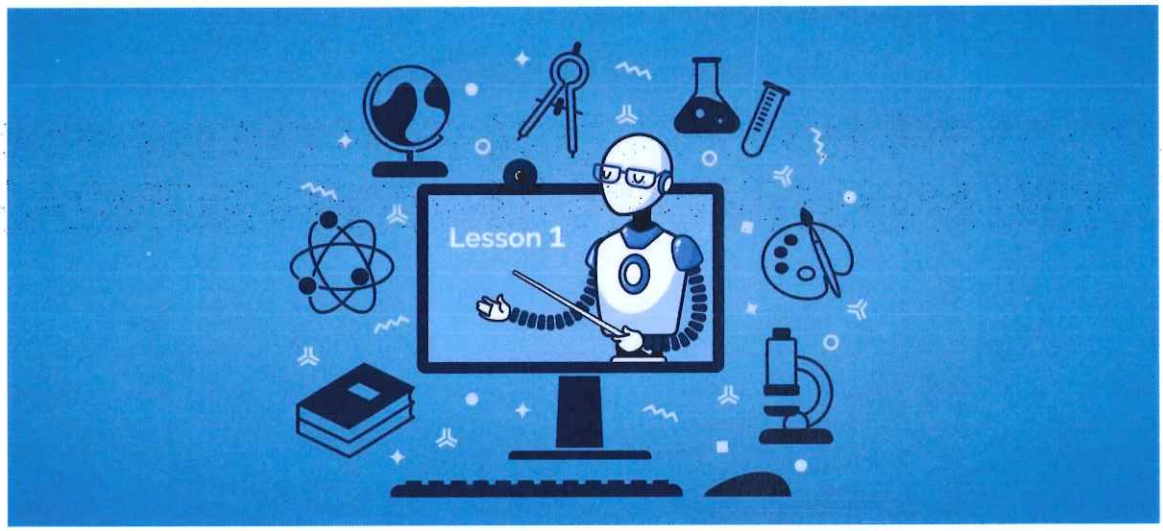
M.M.C.: We want to cover the whole peninsula of the Yucatán, and we want to increase the number of kids participating but that also means we need more donors. I also hope to see more parks around the world sharing knowledge. There are two more organisations that are replicating HUNAB. One is in Paraguay, Para La Tierra, and the other is in the north of Mexico. I hope that soon there will be more HUNAB parks around the world, inspiring kids to protect nature and to protect our Grandmother Earth.

https://edition.cnn.com/2021/02/25/world/maritza-morales-casanova-mexico-yucatan-environment-c2e-hnk-spc-intl/index.html

EXTENSIVE READING 2

The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Education

The use of artificial intelligence (AI) in the classroom often brings up images of robots teaching children, students interacting with soft-voiced software to get things done, or, software and machines replacing teachers and educators. Current developments contain a little of all of these stereotypes, but in ways that benefit both students and teachers and make education a lot more responsive to everyone's needs. Analysts forecast the Artificial Intelligence Market in the US Education Sector to grow at a CAGR of 47.77% during the period 2018-2022. Today's students will work in a future where AI is the reality, so it's critical that educators incorporate and familiarize students with the technology. To better understand the future of AI in the classroom and how it will help teachers and students alike, it is important to see how AI-based education technology is being used in schools and educational institutions right now.



Remote Learning Is A Challenge

The pandemic caught everyone unprepared — especially teachers. Keeping students engaged is difficult when all you have to work with is a screen. A solution to this is the use of Rev Zoom Live Captions to accurately convert speech into text. The high degree of accuracy of the AI-powered captioning service increases accessibility and makes screen content easier to understand. This is particularly important with students who are deaf or hard-of-hearing, when internet connection speeds are not equally great for everyone on a Zoom call, or when not everyone shares the same first language.

AI in Education is Already Here

Before the pandemic, some schools and educational institutions in Australia were already using AI tools in the classroom to help improve learning outcomes for their students. Both Virtual Reality (VR) and Augmented Reality (AR) education technology uses artificial intelligence to create more immersive learning environments. The learning experience changes dramatically when students can interact with the environment they are studying. In addition, interactive learning tools allow students to cooperate on educational projects even when they are not in the same place, making real-time learning possible.

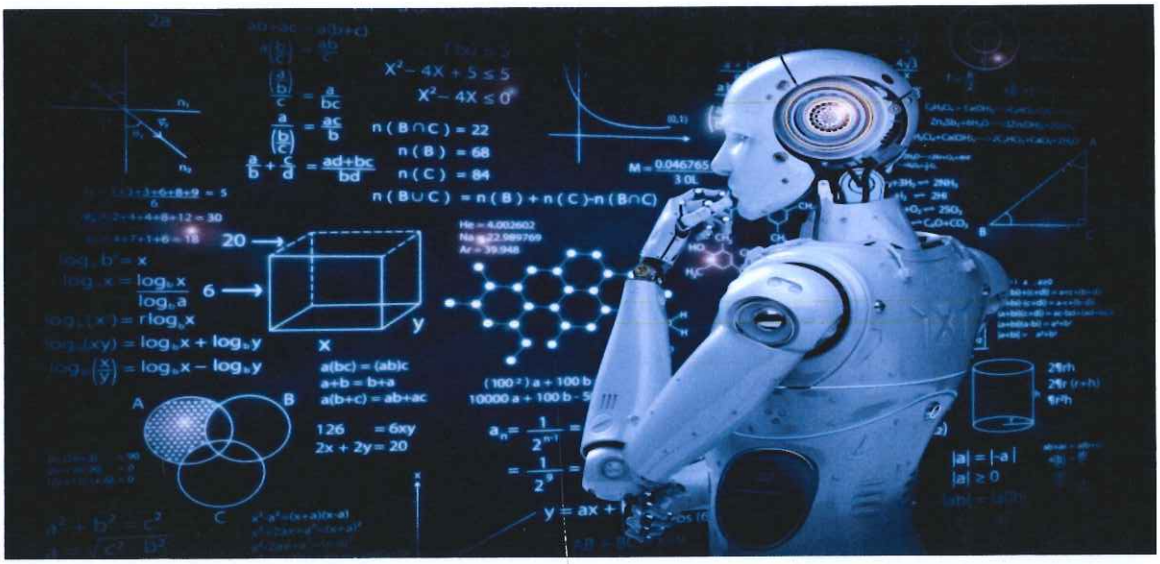
The use of speech-to-text technology and AI powered learning platforms helps enrich students' learning and can make the teachers' job much easier. The real benefits of using artificial intelligence in the classroom, however, lie in the very near future of education. The developments we are likely to see revolve around the core capabilities offered by artificial intelligence:

- Personalization
- Automation
- Adaptation

The Future of Artificial Intelligence in Education

The classroom of the future will likely employ artificial intelligence to better understand and personalize learning for every single student. In a 2015 interview, Bill Gates explained that his Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation had invested nearly a quarter of a billion dollars to fund the development of personalized learning technology.

Teachers, in the past, employed a one-size-fits-all approach to education. Lack of resources and the need to meet specific learning targets by set dates made it necessary to teach to the middle. This ignored the students who outperformed their classmates, and those who were slower to grasp the material.



Artificial intelligence software that learns and adapts to each student's individual needs, however, offers the opportunity for teachers to help exactly where they are needed and it will tailor the learning experience so that no student gets left behind. This is the true personalized approach to learning.

Automation, on the other hand, focuses on making mundane tasks easy for both students and teachers. Students can benefit from using AI technology to make some learning tasks easier. Translating languages in real time, for example, makes knowledge more accessible for students globally. It also helps accelerate comprehension for students learning a second language.

Teachers can benefit from automation with the introduction of automatic grading software that will free up valuable time currently spent marking student papers. Intelligent teaching assistants that can automate some Q & A tasks teachers perform will allow students to access help whenever they need it without soaking up valuable teacher time.

The true benefit of using artificial intelligence in a learning environment is the ability to adapt to changing circumstances. Rev Live Captions are just one real-life example of how AI can help institutions quickly adapt to a developing educational need. Such solutions can help improve student engagement during remote learning and even provide post-meeting transcripts for additional study-aid material.

In the future, education will be faster paced and educational needs much more varied. Recognizing trends before they take hold and adapting quickly is an area in which artificial intelligence can be of huge help.

The educational institution of the future will be able to change its curriculum when necessary. Its students will benefit from supplementary teaching technologies without adding extra burdens on teachers, and teachers will be able to use their time and skills more creatively.

The Future is Almost Here

A Rand Corporation research paper on the use of artificial intelligence in learning platforms shows that a mix of machine learning and AI tools are already transforming education. This is not happening at the same pace everywhere, however.

The popular science fiction writer, William Gibson, once said, "The future is already here, it's just not evenly distributed." His words ring particularly true when it comes to the application of AI in teaching and learning. The evolution of education has only just begun.

https://www.rev.com/blog/the-role-of-artificial-intelligence-in-education

EXTENSIVE READING 3

Become a UN Youth Volunteer

UN Youth Volunteers are between 18 and 29 years old, and work with UN agencies on the frontlines of political, developmental and humanitarian operations.

Who are UN Youth Volunteers?

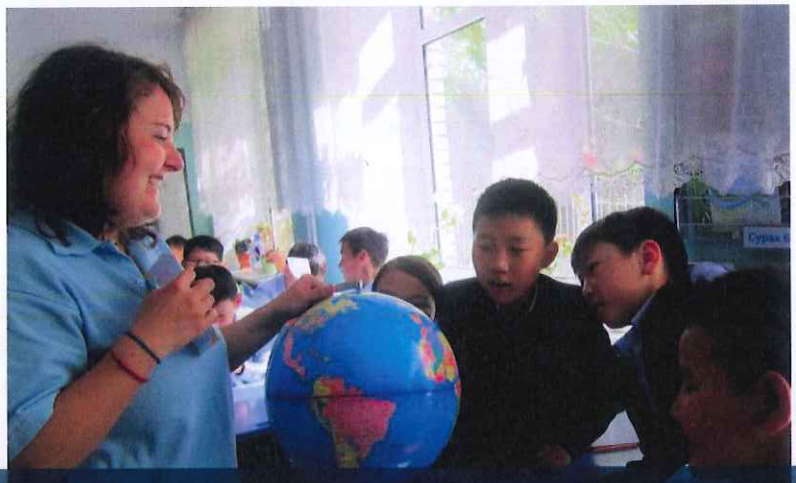
UN Youth Volunteers are a separate category of UN Volunteers recently created in response to the United Nations Secretary-General's call for greater engagement in volunteerism of history's largest generation of people under 30. UN Youth Volunteers help the United Nations – one of the world's most important intergovernmental organizations - to fulfill its mission. These young volunteers are assigned to host United Nations agencies to work on the frontlines of political, developmental and humanitarian field operations. UN Youth Volunteers are young people aged 18 to 29 years who want to engage in development and peace initiatives worldwide.

What do UN Youth Volunteers do?

As a UN Youth Volunteer, you will help advance peace and sustainable development either in your own country or in another country around the globe. You will help people to lead healthier and safer lives and communities to be able to better address present and future challenges.

UN Youth Volunteer positions are wide ranging; you may work in human rights, climate change adaptation, primary health care, disaster management, peace building, youth engagement or many other areas. You may work directly in a United Nations agency or be assigned to one of its partner organizations, a university or the government.

In return, you will be rewarded with an experience that will stay with you for the rest of your life. Your engagement as a UN Youth Volunteer will be an opportunity to change the world for the better while simultaneously honing your own skills, gaining knowledge and a better understanding of the realities of international development and peace building.



Stepanka Pechackova (Czech Republic), UN Youth Volunteer in Communications, Outreach and Youth with the UNV Field Unit and UNDP Country Office in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia (Soyombo Makhbal, UNV Mongolia, 2015)

How long is the assignment?

Because UN Youth Volunteers are sponsored by United Nations agencies, their partners, governments or academic institutions, the length of assignment depends on the requesting entity's needs. Most UN Youth Volunteer assignments are between six and 24 months. On occasion, national and international UN Youth Volunteer assignments are less than six months and then are referred to as 'short-term' assignments.

When UN Youth Volunteers are sponsored by an academic institution, they are called UN Youth University Volunteers. UN Youth University Volunteers undertake shorter duration assignments – generally between three and six months.

UN Youth Volunteers receive a basic living allowance that allows the volunteer to live healthily and safely in the assigned area. If you volunteer outside of your home area, return airfare or land transport (as applicable) and some other basic costs are paid by the host agency. You will receive orientation and training before and after your assignment.

Who qualifies as a UN Youth Volunteer?

The UN Youth Volunteer programme is looking for motivated and talented youth between the ages of 18 and 29. (Note: you must be younger than 29 throughout the duration of your service). The educational background and experience required varies by assignment, but generally work experience over two years is not expected.

Am I the right fit?

Because the United Nations Volunteers (UNV) programme has built a reputation for recruiting and fielding the highest caliber volunteers that the world has to offer, no less is expected of UN Youth Volunteers. Here is a checklist to see if the UN Youth Volunteer programme is right for you:

- Am I committed to global peace and development?
- Am I motivated and enthusiastic?
- Can I adapt readily to new cultures and situations?
- Will I dedicate between six and twenty-four months to the volunteer assignment?
- Asset: Am I interested in or have I done any volunteering or community work in my country or elsewhere?

How to apply?

All UN Youth Volunteer assignments to volunteer abroad are advertised in our website (under Special Calls for Volunteers). We also advertise assignments to volunteer in your country. We also advertise vacancies for youth via Facebook, Twitter and LinkedIn. As these assignments go fast, we encourage you to check the sources above on a regular basis. Details on qualifications and how to apply are included in the advertisement for each assignment.

https://www.unv.org/become-un-youth-volunteer

EXTENSIVE READING 4

Why Does Art Matter?

Why does art matter? What value does it hold in society? Why should you support artists? If you've ever asked yourself any of these questions, you're not alone. Philosophers have been debating the subject for centuries, speculating whether or not art delivers true value to the world.

The answer to the question: *why does art matter?* is a loaded one, but it must be answered. After all, artists from around the world continue to produce stunning original artworks that cause us to laugh, cry, and ponder, so there must be *something* to it.
In this article, we're reopening the discussion of why does art matter, and giving you some ideas as to how you can support artists who deliver so much value to our society.

1. Art Reminds Us Who We Are

In an age dominated by technological advancement, sometimes it's easy to forget that we are in fact human beings with complicated emotions that must be expressed.

Art reminds us that:

- We can always be ourselves
- Beauty still exists in the world
- We can connect on a deep, spiritual level

When you encounter a truly great painting, the question of *why does art matter* becomes abundantly obvious: it allows us to look inward and understand ourselves more truly. An original piece of artwork opens us to a new understanding of the self. And with that understanding of the self, we are able to move through the world more fully.

2. Art as a Means of Escapism

Do you ever feel the need to step away from the fast-paced world to escape all the trials and tribulations that life throws at us?

Art provides that opportunity. Whether it be a sculpture in our bathroom that ignites our imagination, or a photograph from a faraway place that takes us away from the present moment, art lets us feel free.

When an artist sets out to craft a piece of work, *why does art matter* is always in the back of their minds. They're trying to create pieces that truly speak to its viewers to deliver escapist value to everyone that looks upon it.

3. Art Allows For Cultural Exchange

Just as the economy allows us to trade with people who are different from us, art allows us to connect with those from different backgrounds on a spiritual level.By engaging with artists from around the world, we become more empathetic and understanding of cultures from our own.

And in the end, we are called back to Reason #1: we are reminded that we are all human. While we might live life differently than others, we still share the common thread of humanity.

So, why does art matter?
Because we are able to understand one another more truly. We are able to set our differences aside and come together over something miraculous and magical, which is priceless.

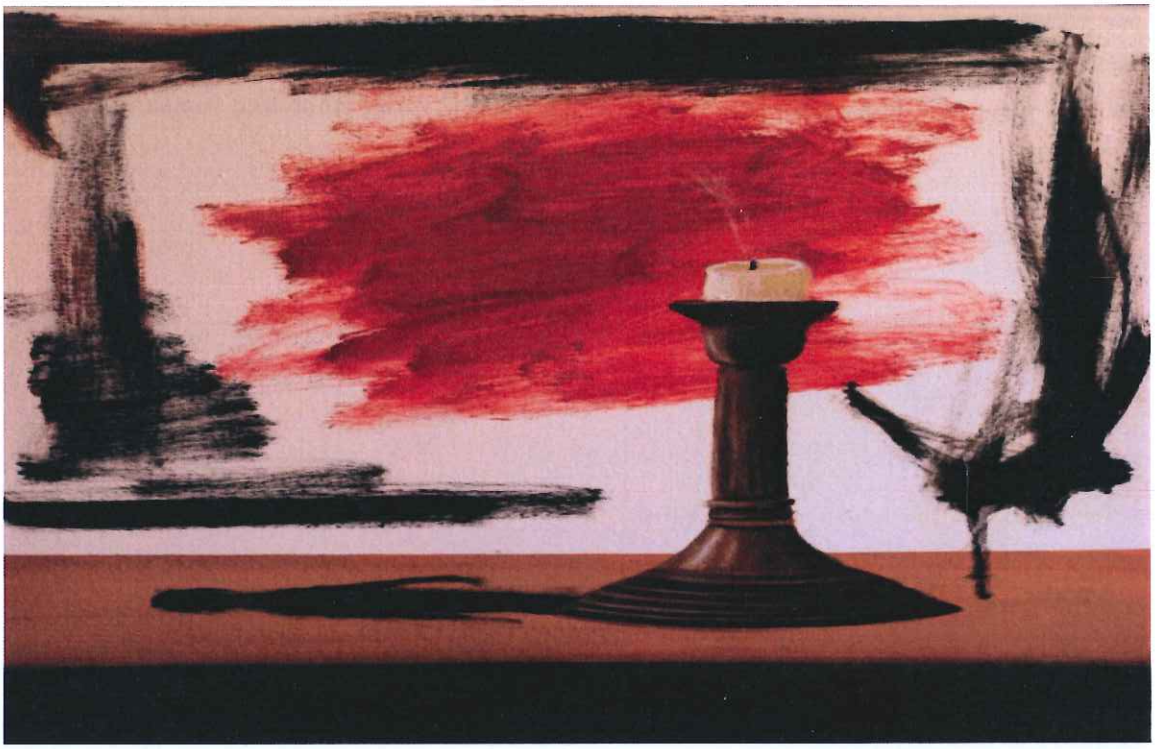
4. Art Gives Our World Light and Beauty

Still asking yourself why does art matter?
If you haven't bought into the first three reasons, let us give you this: in a world filled with trauma and loss, artwork permits us to remember that life is a beautiful thing meant to be shared.

We've all been called to learn a difficult lesson during the pandemic. The global system is more fragile than we thought.But art rises above tragedy. Art endures. While economies have crashed and people have lost their lives, artists continue to produce works that inspire us to keep moving.

5. Art Provides Balance

Sometimes, it can feel that the only reason we were called to earth is for *work*. Our jobs, social lives, and responsibilities ask a lot of us. Art works as the great equalizer to this effect. Whether you are looking to produce art or consumer art, it's always a powerful experience. We need to take time out of our lives to admire and appreciate beauty. Without it, we become too invested in our work and social systems that cannot satisfy the needs of the soul. There is a reason that early humans started producing artwork on cave walls more than 50,000 years ago. Because it was *in* them. And art is in us. Even if you don't consider yourself to be an outwardly artistic person, that doesn't mean that you don't need it to fill your life.



When asking yourself *why does art matter*, take a selfish approach. Art matters because it's a part of your unique self!

Conclusions: Why Does Art Matter?
It's time to answer the question for yourself: Why *does* art matter?

In our opinion, art:

- Reminds us who we are
- Allows us to escape
- Provides opportunity for cultural exchange
- Shows us that the world is still beautiful
- Gives balances to our lives

So, are you a believer?
If so, it's time to **introduce art into your life**. What story can art tell in your life? It's time to find out.

https://gallerima.com/magazine/why-does-art-matter-top-5-reasons-to-support-artists/